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Virginia Board of Education, Business Meeting, Thursday, June 18, 2020

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- Official meeting video (VDOE, YouTube): https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=e7xKkm2V8Ok
- Board of Education meetings, agendas and minutes (VDOE): https://www.doe.virginia.gov/state-board-data-funding/virginia-board-of-education

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[00:00:00] We got what we got. - I understand. I'm very orange-red today. I can't figure out how to change it, whatever. - No, we're not streaming live on YouTube, so. - She's just taking a minute to get us live on the public page and we should be able to start right at 10, although I guess Dr. Lane's in another meeting which ends right now, so he should be joining any moment.

[00:00:26] - Good.

[00:00:28] Make sure his priorities are in the right place.

[00:01:31] Okay, how are we doing, Emily? - We're not quite there and we'll give folks another couple of minutes to hop on too. - Fine. - We'll give them just two minutes.

[00:01:50] - Remember the good old days when I used to control when we started. - Hopefully we'll get back to that. - I missed the gavel. - None of this late stuff. - So we are now live on both the VDOE YouTube page and your public meeting page, but we'll give folks just another minute to have them hop on.

[00:02:29] Have we seen Pam yet? - She is gonna be joining us at 11:00 today. - That's right, she's at the school meetings. - Yeah, she has a conflict, correct. - Fine, sorry, I was just taking a roll call on my mind here of who's here.

[00:02:52] - Yep, all righty, I think we have almost everybody.

[00:03:13] So, President Gecker, I'll go ahead and turn it over to you. - Great, well, welcome to everybody. It's always good to see all of you. I guess some of you don't like the cameras, so maybe not as good to see you guys, but it certainly is good to be together once again.

[00:03:32] The board met yesterday, and now we'll go ahead with the regular business meeting. I will say that given the interruption caused by the pandemic, our ability to get a few things done was limited. I'm glad to see us getting back into the swing of things, even if it is still virtual.

[00:03:53] As is clear we are in a virtual meeting. It is being streamed live on the VDOE YouTube channel and on the board's public meeting web page. We'd like to welcome those joining us on the live stream from across the Commonwealth. A couple of things to note about the meeting. You know, one of the saddest things for us is that the platform does not really allow for the acceptance of live public comment. And it is something the board takes seriously and something the board actually, you know, misses in this format.

[00:04:23] the board did accept written public comment for the meeting you know all comments that were received by 5:00 p.m. yesterday have been uploaded to the meeting web page comments received after 5:00 p.m. will be provided to the board in a timely manner and posted on our meeting web page I will say you know the comments that came in this month we're in a couple distinct categories and as we get down to the last item on the agenda there will be some discussion current issues we will have some discussion and response uh general response to a number of those

[00:05:00] uh written comments in addition uh to the extent required staff will respond in writing to all the comments received for the youtube watchers uh the chat feature is not being monitored by staff the best way to contact the board is by email at boe at doe.virginia.gov uh and since we are meeting virtually for those on the board. There's a need for a roll call vote for each item.

[00:05:29] Emily says this, not me. Please be sure to speak clearly so staff can accurately capture your vote for the meeting minutes. I, of course, know you would always speak clearly without that reminder and would not have put that in. I will also note at the beginning, and we'll talk about this a little bit more at the end, that this is the final meeting for one of our stalwart members, Diane Atkinson who has been on the board longer than anybody can remember and frankly has provided more insight and really direction than could ever really could be told accurately. You know we have

[00:06:08] decided to sort of postpone the farewell until we can be together but I will tell you it is a very sad day for me, because, you know, we've served in, you know, leadership capacities on this board together. We've become friends on this board together. And, you know, just the insights and the institutional knowledge, and frankly, the common sense that Diane brings will be sorely missed. But we'll talk a little bit more about that at the end. And we will also, as I said,

[00:06:43] have a, you know, full session where I can cry in public when we're all together. You know, I don't think I can do this too much right now. This is truly a great loss for the board. All right. We will move on to the consent agenda.

[00:07:01] Items A through D. Has everybody had... My screen just went, but I guess you're sharing now, Emily. Has everybody had a chance to review those items? Are there any items that we need to pull off the consent agenda? And if not, is there a motion to adopt the consent agenda as it seems?

[00:07:21] - President Gecker, we also need to adopt the minutes. - Ah, okay, somehow I missed that on my list here. All right. - And do a roll call. - Yeah, we'll do the roll call, that's fair. All right, clearly out of order today.

[00:07:38] So roll call first, just to make sure everybody's here. I'm here, Ms. Atkinson, I think they want you to say yes, Diane. - I need to unmute myself, yes.

[00:07:53] - Okay, Ms. Davis-Vault, we know is not. Dr. Duran. - Present. - Ms. Holton. - Present. - Dr. Mann. - Present. - Dr. Pexton.

[00:08:09] - Present. - And Dr. Wilson. - Present. - Thank you for the reminder, Emily. Has everybody had a chance to review the minutes of the May 7 and June 2 meetings? If so, is there a motion to approve or to amend?

[00:08:27] - President Decker, I move that we approve the minutes of both May 7, 2020, and June 2, 2020. - Thank you, Dr. Wilson.

[00:08:36] there a second? Second. Thank you, Dr. Duran. Again, by roll call, Ms. Atkinson? Aye. Dr. Duran? Aye. Ms. Holton? Aye. Dr. Mann? Aye. Dr. Pexton? Aye. Dr. Wilson? Aye. And I vote aye. Okay. Now the consent agenda. Again, is there any desire to pull any items from the consent agenda, or is there a motion to adopt the consent agenda as is?

[00:09:10] - I'll make a motion to adopt the consent agenda as is. - Great, motion to approve. Thank you, Dr. Duran, is there a second to that? - I second it. - Thank you, Ms. Atkinson. Again, roll call on this.

[00:09:26] Ms. Atkinson? - Aye. - Dr. Duran? - Aye. - Ms. Holton? - Aye. - Dr. Mann? - Aye. - Dr. Pexton? - Aye. - And Dr. Wilson?

[00:09:42] - Aye. - Okay, move on to item E. Final review of the advisory board teacher education licensure recommendations to establish an economics and personal finance add-on endorsement in the licensure regs for school personnel etc good morning president gecker members of the board and dr lane it certainly is my privilege to present this to you this morning these recommendations were presented to you last month so i will briefly recap highlights currently

[00:10:16] no specific endorsement has been established in board regulations to teach courses in economics and personal finance teachers holding valid virginia licenses with endorsements in specific areas of career and technical education history and social science and mathematics may teach these courses a work group was established and recommendations were presented to abtel and i do want to extend my gratitude to both the work group and Aptill for their work. The recommendation is

[00:10:52] for an add-on endorsement, which means that the individual requesting this endorsement must already hold a renewable teaching license, postgraduate professional license, or collegiate professional license, or a provisional license leading to a renewable license. The Superintendent of Public Instruction recommends that the Board of Education approve Aptill's recommendations regarding the timeline to allow teachers to be grandfathered, including the no-cost teachers

[00:11:24] to add the endorsement. He also is recommending the requirements that the workgroup and Abtel submitted to be incorporated in the regulations governing the review and approval of education programs in Virginia. The Superintendent of Public Instruction is recommending revisions to the proposed requirements to be included in the licensure regulations. The workgroup in AVTO

[00:11:55] recommended six semester hours of economics or three semester hours of economics and a non-college credit institute in economics, which must be a minimum of 45 o'clock hours and must be offered by a school division or a regionally accredited college or university. The superintendent is is recommending a revision to that particular requirement to read three semester hours of

[00:12:28] economics or a non-college credit institute in economics, maintaining the remainder of that requirement that the institute must be a minimum of 45 o'clock hours offered by a school division or college or university. Additionally, the work group and Aptel recommended

[00:12:51] Kathy Sweedler: Six semester hours of economics or three semester hours on person. I'm sorry, six semester hours of personal finance or on they recommended three semester hours on a personal finance and a non college credit institute and funding.

[00:13:16] Superintendents recommending that that be changed to three semester hours of personal finance or a non-college credit institute in finance. So those are the recommendations from Aptel and the Superintendent of Public Instruction.

[00:13:32] I'll be happy to answer any questions that you may have. Are there any questions by board members first? Mr. Gecker, I have a question. Please. Thank you. Ms. Pitts, thanks for that overview.

[00:13:47] It may be helpful for us to, I remember when we had this item presented last time, there was some conversation about the number of hours and a desire to look at that, but it may be helpful to remind the public and the board what the rationale is for reducing the number of credit hours from basically six to three in both categories.

[00:14:10] So it would be helpful to have that reminder, please. Thanks, Patty, I'll take that on. Thanks, Dr. Wilson. When we started to work on this originally with just the Virginia Council for Economic Education, even before we took this to ABTEL, we had imagined that this endorsement would be something that would provide every teacher in the Commonwealth that teaches this course the understanding necessary to teach the course, but would not be overly burdensome to our teachers.

[00:14:48] now even though teachers that have been teaching the pre course previously will not have to go through this process this was a position this was a requirement that essentially was was not funded of school districts uh when when it was made a requirement though we agree with the requirement so it required school divisions to use a variety of staff members whether it was uh and i i have known a fiscal education teachers that have taught this uh to cte teachers to math teachers and so whereas we agree that it's extremely important that uh that there's a basic knowledge of economics

[00:15:24] and personal finance to teach the course uh taking four college level courses felt like it was overly burdensome to our teachers uh and and certainly i've seen the comments that say well we at least do six in this one and even if it's three in this one and i i even think three courses is still too much and so we felt really strongly that two courses total or these two institutes was the right way to approach it in our mind we had always thought of this being done by institute we gave the options for a semester hour certainly because that's that's always a possibility but

[00:15:59] what we envisioned is that our our teachers would go to an institute in the summer get the training they need therefore they would essentially receive the two micro credentials necessary to get the the add-on endorsement and and so this was not burdensome and could be done in a short time frame over the summer in one to two weeks. Thank you. May I ask a follow-on question?

[00:16:23] Do we know of any other, off the top of your head, any other add-on endorsements which require two courses as opposed to four? I suspect Aptel was thinking about kind of our historical path on for add-on endorsements, a number of courses required. And I'll let, Patty, I know Patty will answer this in detail but this is this is a lower requirement than is typically done with our add-on endorsements but it's also a very unique course uh that uh is uh in the way that we structured it

[00:16:59] but i i will openly admit that this is a lower requirement than you've seen in the past for add-on endorsement yeah and i just want to make sure we acknowledge differences that we are drawing here for those who may not be as familiar with add-on endorsement requirements so that's my that's the reason i'm asking the question thanks dr lee we do have a similar requirement for driver education which requires six semester hours of credit and also for keyboarding so it's not unprecedented that this would require less hours than some of our other add-on endorsements thank

[00:17:35] you very much you're welcome we did receive comment from dan mortensen i guess suggesting that uh you know the council does not believe that you can get enough economics knowledge in the three you know go ahead miss halton mr yeah mr president yeah i i i i think both uh dan martinson and the virginia chamber of commerce weighed in uh suggesting that at least in the

[00:18:11] economics area there be two credit two three-hour credit courses can i ask a a a a a couple of clarifying questions for for my own understanding um um if first of all am i right that abtel agreed with the work group on the higher level of requirements and it's the superintendent's recommendation that we uh make a more modest uh requirement abtel did support the work of the

[00:18:44] work group yes okay then so to understand that recommendation am am i correct that if and this is displaying my ignorance but if a student as an undergraduate if a teacher as an undergraduate you know 30 years ago took both microeconomics and macroeconomics that would meet the requirement for the economics in other words it's not a regular update it's not something they have to do each time they renew their license is that correct that is correct if individuals had already completed these courses which someone for example endorsed in business education typically would have

[00:19:22] completed such courses we would not require that they be repeated and then so if I understand the to understand the recommendation as as submitted by Abtel and the work group one could meet the economics requirement by taking two three credit courses or by attending College Institute is that correct or I'm confused by the or and the and they were recommending that an individual complete

[00:20:02] either six semester hours or three semester hours and an institute of 45 o'clock hours so they were saying either two college courses or one college course the summer institute yes ma'am and what this and then is recommending is that either one college well either one college course or the summer institute uh so or the 45 hour and i assume both for both economics and finance yes

[00:20:40] and i'm going to assume that the 45-hour institute is very specifically designed to enable to cover the material that needs to be taught in these courses. Absolutely and it will have to cover the competencies that are outlined in your agenda item that would be included for any approved program offering this as an add-on endorsement and it's also important to note that such curriculum would have to be approved by the Department of Education. It's not something that

[00:21:17] a school division or an institution of higher education could offer without being vetted by the department of education first so and let just last question as long as we keep the word or rather than and if

we were to go to the six credit hour requirement for economics a current teacher you know that would mean a teacher who had taken microeconomics and macroeconomics back when they were in college however long ago that was would meet the requirement or that a teacher who had

[00:21:53] not could go to the 45-hour institute in the summer and meet the requirement yes but if i can just explain context of how how these decisions get made in local school divisions so let's say that you decided to take our recommendation of six hours total which is the the three or the non-credit and the three or the non-credit to a six or a non-credit to a three or a non-credit, you're essentially requiring teachers to take three 45-hour experiences if you add the additional

[00:22:28] course. And just functionally how this happens in school divisions, you know, if a teacher that's teaching economics and personal finance now leaves, that means that a new teacher will actually have to go through this process. And typically the superintendent or the principal will come to the teacher and say, hey, it's May. We need a teacher to teach economics and personal finance next year.

[00:22:50] Would you be willing to do it? And right now, because there's no add-on endorsement, they pretty much flexibly can get anybody into it. We had always envisioned in our initial conversations when we agreed to take this forward, that this would be something that a teacher could do quickly in the summer to get the training. Because what will happen is if you require nine hours, whether that's three 45-hour experiences, most teachers are not going to be able to do that in one summer.

[00:23:15] they'll come back to the fall and they will not be endorsed and then and then the school division will run into a huge issue and the more requirements you put on an endorsement like this for just one course you could end up putting the school division in a position where they're going to have a shortage and there i just don't believe there is any teacher it's going to be hard enough to get them to do six hours to get them to do nine in one summer feels completely uh egregious so if i may just one more i'm sorry i'm clearly confused i thought that it will well i thought i i'm

[00:23:52] suggesting an option and maybe that's not what either you or abtel is recommending whereby a teacher could meet the requirements with the two 45-hour summer institutes one in economics and one in finance or if they wanted the institute in either of those subjects they could they take the college course requirement instead and so in other words i don't think it would be three 45-hour requirements i think it would be either you prove you've taken econ the equivalent of

[00:24:30] microeconomics and macroeconomics or you do the summer course and and i would say from our stand from my standpoint with my recommendation uh are you saying that on top of that you would also require the course in personal finance so i'm saying that the i would go with your recommendation as to personal finance as to economics i would say a teacher should shouldn't a teacher be able to meet the requirement either by taking the summer course that we approve the content of

[00:25:02] or by taking two college classes so in other words if they take the summer if they take the summer institute in economics and finance they'll be fine but if they want to skip the if they want to be excused from the summer institute in economics they will have to prove that they've taken both microeconomics and macroeconomics or two equivalent college level economics classes so i'm not saying i'm not advocating for three unless they want in other words they can do two college or the one summer institute to meet the economics requirement i'm sorry i'm being so

[00:25:41] inarticulate would that meet your concern and would that also consistent i thought that was what dr uh mr mortensen and and uh the chamber were advocating for but i may what they were recommending was six semester hours in economics or three semester hours of college credit in economics

[00:26:13] and an institute so what they are recommending really both would be equivalent to 90 hours of instruction either way that's what they're recommending oh i understand that was the original work group recommendation but what doctor what mr mortensen and mr martin are recommending now is that this uh i thought they backed off of that i think the focus of their comments really

[00:26:44] surrounded the college coursework um because they did not want that reduced from six to three i'm not sure that they totally addressed the other option so okay i think you're i think you're right looking back at it that one of the changes the superintendent is suggesting that we change the word and to or and not address that okay uh any other comments on this mr gecker yes dr dron

[00:27:22] Yes, I fully support the superintendent's recommendation, and I appreciate how we articulated the challenge that will occur when we're trying to find teachers to be able to teach these courses, and I appreciate that this is a good balanced approach. I read the comments that Ms. Holton was referring to a moment ago that we received, and I did take those into consideration, but I do think that this is a balanced approach to help teachers get the add-on that they need with the proper support through the non-college credit institute the school districts could do so i do think that the superintendent dr lane put some good thought into this and i fully support

[00:28:00] that as a balanced movement forward thank you any other comments mr gecker i'll just say you know miss pitt's observation and acknowledgement that the institute itself the curriculum for either the institute or the coursework is vetted by the department is a key point and so ensuring that the intended instruction or learning of those among those teachers who are going to be teaching the course it will be very important and so in advance thanking the board the department rather for the

[00:28:39] work that they're going to do to ensure that the structure of those institutes and courses meet our needs for our students well how important is the prior exposure for these teachers to micro and macroeconomics i think that's what this is coming down to it's how how in depth that we've been in their background with regard to those two subjects i think it can be covered in a 45-hour experience but i think it's important but i think it's uh you know it's it's in preparation for a

[00:29:15] high school level course okay any other comments um i just want to acknowledge that i just went back to the public comment and reviewed it again and the one from the council does in fact um suggest six hours and it's either three and an institute or two two two sets of three at college

[00:29:47] level just to clarify so so my my uh proposed uh perhaps friendly amendment to the superintendent's recommendation would be that and maybe this is by way of a compromise but that either two college courses or the summer institute in economics and that if anything might push people towards the the summer institute but that we would excuse them from doing the summer institute if they had taken both to the the six hours in college and that's all on the economic side on the finance side

[00:30:26] i my i would be comfortable with the superintendent's recommendation and if there's uh mr president i don't i don't know what whether there's if there's enough uh interest then i'll propose it as an

amendment and if not i'll waste our time yeah i'm interested in it so that's there's some interest is there any other interest in that type of proposal Dr. Paxton I this is Diane I could

[00:31:03] support that proposal I think it goes a ways to acknowledging what the council has put forward but does provide the flexibility for a teacher to accomplish that in the 45 minute 45 hour course institute i and i know you're assessing sorry go ahead no i just wanted to make sure i was understanding miss holton's recommendation uh because right now these things are talked about

[00:31:39] together economics and personal finance and i was trying to appreciate the decoupling or the differentiation for these two content areas so were you recommending something different for yeah yeah happy to be i'll be specific looking at item e the highlighted i uh language uh under 2a

[00:32:10] i would change the word three to six but i would keep the word or so it would lead on uh on economics it would read six semester hours of economics or a non-college credit institute in economics and then i would not make any changes to the superintendent's recommendations with respect to to be the personal finance language miss holton can i ask a clarifying question yes uh miss holton so when we do that though are you making are you using the alone the non-college

[00:32:50] credit institute to be 45 hours or because we're now doubling the six semester hours of economics in your proposal are you then suggesting that the non-college credit institute be doubled as well so that would be 90? No, sir. No. If you haven't had it in college or haven't had macro/micro separated, you end up doing the 45-hour institute. Okay, thank you. With that, as long as we're not doubling the non-college credit, I would be amenable to that suggestion. If I can just make sure you fully understand the context of that decision, there may only be one non-college

[00:33:30] credit institute offered every school year and uh if that happens and the teacher cannot attend the non-college credit institute in their community which and certainly this is this is this is better i'll tell you why i would maintain my recommendation if they missed that one week that would be offered in their community you are then requiring them to take six hours and i i do think that that's a lot and keep in mind that even in the version that allowed three hours in and economics and the non-college credit institute which is what they had that they had before as an

[00:34:09] option they there was there was never a requirement that a teacher would have to take both courses because there was always an assumption that some of that content could be covered in the non-college credit institute and so i i i'm really fearful about the burden on teachers if if they cannot attend that non-college credit institute so with that sorry um dr lane to interrupt no you're fine

[00:34:35] But just to clarify, is there anything that precludes a teacher from accessing, I understand the challenge perhaps of an institute not being held in their community or neighboring community, but is there anything that precludes a teacher from taking a course that may be offered virtually or by some other division or university as long as that institution or entity allows access?

[00:35:04] So I hear your concern about access to the course, but I'm just thinking about the extent to which that could be a real burden or barrier to access. - Yeah, so to date, I'm really only familiar with one or two existing non-college credit institutes.

[00:35:25] And frankly, I think VCEE runs one of them. And so that's, for full disclosure in their advocacy, or intends to run one of them anyways and so let's say that's only offered once or twice a summer if the teacher misses that and you take miss holton's amendment then the teacher has to take six hours of

economics on top of whatever they have to do in personal finance and so if you if you add that requirement you are essentially de facto requiring a teacher if they miss

[00:35:59] the non-collection institute to take six hours in economics um and uh our hope would be that if the teacher met the institute they could do one course and still get into teaching the course uh and because you got to keep in mind right now this course is being taught with no requirements and so to go from no requirements to the potential for nine is is going to be a huge concern to school divisions and teachers that have to do this and i say the potential for nine i understand that there their options. Let me ask, because I guess I don't know, Dan, you know, I just don't have a feel for

[00:36:37] this. How many people get out of college without taking any economics? I mean, my daughter, who's a support management major at ODU, has got six hours of economics. We did micro and macro. I know this because I did it with her for a lot of it to help her through it. Yeah, economics is typically, and I'll let her higher ed people, but it can typically be one of the options that you take for social studies or elective, it is highly likely that students can graduate from college without a course in economics. Okay so now we're down I mean doesn't that give them at least three

[00:37:13] right there so the idea they'd have to take six now is not really right? No I'm saying it's highly likely that it's highly likely that a student would have no economics coming out of college. It's certainly I have to agree with Dr. Lane here that it that it is not necessarily mandated that students take now how many students in fact do take some economics i don't know but uh but it is not i went and checked at my university it is not required

[00:37:49] that a student take a course any course in economics they have to meet a social science requirement not specifically in economics that is definitely the case from evaluating credentials we know that to be true but they should be for what it's worth any encouragement we can give them to take more economics. Okay, I think we have a proposal on the table. Are there any other comments? Is there a motion on this? Could you clarify which proposal is currently on

[00:38:25] the table? Well, I guess I shouldn't have said that because there's none technically until we have a motion, but I think that Ann is going to make a motion with regard to hers, and that one will be the one on the table. I'm sorry, Diane, you're right. Yeah, I'm happy to get it started without i'll propose i i will move that we adopt the superintendent's recommendations on this item with the change on um in 2a of item e of the word three to six in 2a only okay is there a second to

[00:39:03] that i would second okay we have a second any further discussion yes uh i was amenable to that and I'm kind of on the fence with it, but after hearing Dr. Lane's comments further, I'm not going to be in support of that. Okay. All right. Any other discussion? If not, we'll go to the vote.

[00:39:29] Ms. Atkinson? I'm going to say no. Dr. Durang? No. Ms. Holton? Yes. Dr. Mann? No. Dr. Pexton? Yes.

[00:39:46] and i'm going yes uh yes to that so where does that put us that's uh that was going to fail for dr wilson you needed to have not voted sorry dr wilson thank you i vote yes okay well that carries that thank you sorry about that jamil that's okay sometimes my handwriting is not as easy to read as i'd like it to be even by me okay uh we will move on then to item f uh dr sale can

[00:40:24] you guys hear me yes thank you terrific um and let me just get my document pulled up so i can be prepared for any questions um so good morning president gecker vice president atkinson dr lane and

members of the board um in front of you this morning we have a second look at our emergency guidelines for the locally awarded verified credit process which the board originally heard back at the April 2nd meeting I know it's we've probably felt like we've lived many lifetimes

[00:41:00] since the last time we picked up this document but hopefully this this still looks fairly familiar to you all so we'll be able to to kind of approach this pretty quickly since there aren't many substantive changes here but just as a refresher of our kind of original conversation around this document so this document was originally brought to the board in the beginning of April as a complement to a number of different waivers and flexibilities that the superintendent had offered our students in high school particularly our graduating high school students in order to get

[00:41:36] them across the finish line in terms of standard units of credit and verified units of credit and so for our verified credits in particular this document recognized that that when we you know make approve these waivers and flexibility measures there was a second bucket and cohort of students that weren't necessarily captured and that's that all of the the they were similarly affected by the extended school closures i guess i should say so all of those students who weren't

[00:42:09] graduating this year and are graduating in the 2020 and 2020 2020 2021 cohort and beyond The extended school closures still still meant that they you know likely experienced some sort of gap instruction for their courses that they were enrolled in in the spring semester.

[00:42:28] These students also had to adapt to changes in instructional delivery and the modality of their instruction and then of course with the the suspension of our SOL administration in the spring the most common pathway to earning a verified credit being passing the corresponding and of course SOL test wasn't immediately on the table so that will you know these students will have the opportunity to test in the fall but given all of these variables that you know this particular group of students may not have been set up for for success on the test in the same way that they

[00:43:02] might have been otherwise under normal conditions instructional and testing conditions so one of the big things that this document did so it reaffirmed a lot of the the waivers and flexibility measures that we put in place just kind of for posterity sake and to make sure that there was consistence in the board's documents with the waiver and flexibility measures but the biggest item was that it created an additional pathway to the locally awarded verified credit so it still required a local review panel that made sure that these students were were reaching a threshold for

[00:43:39] mastery but because of the volume and quantity student of students that might be using or exercising this flexibility and pathway to get to the locally awarded verified credit it expanded some different ways that that these local review panels can look at at these students in batches and think about mastery in a different way so it streamed streamlined that locally awarded verified credit process so that is what the document had done as of april 2nd um and and as you all know now with a few months of additional perspective and we kind of understand the scope and the depth of um you know the impact of the

[00:44:17] virus and the extended school closures and i've had the opportunity to get some additional feedback from input or from stakeholders and and those affected by the school closures um we realized that there was there was probably another segment of students that weren't captured in the original document but would really truly benefit from this additional flexibility with regards to earning verified

credits and so what this document does is it speaks to that as you are scrolling through your board item you'll notice that there are two iterations of this document the first one is a

[00:44:52] red line document so you'll see a lot of highlighted content which reflects new information and then some red line information which reflects outdated or or language being pulled from the document and then of course the second part part of the attachment is where all of those edits are incorporated so you can read them a little bit more easily and there's a better flow if you're digesting the information to look at the red line document it probably appears that we made more substantive changes than is actually the case a few of the edits are just based on the fact that

[00:45:27] we have more information now than we did at the time as of April 2nd so we you know made as as simple as some tense changes in the documents and then a big portion of it is a little bit of reorganization of the document so as we added this new kind of bucket of students that are in are eligible for this pathway it made sense to kind of break out a few pieces of the conversation so with that being said i'll kind of jump into the what i consider the two substantive changes in this new document um the first being that you know in the original document we acknowledge that

[00:46:07] the impact on on our students that might be taking courses in the summer 2020 term was still tentative um that no longer being the case that we have expanded all of the flexibilities to both our students that were enrolled in high school credit bearing courses eligible for verified credits sorry that's a mouthful in spring of 2020 the flexibility that's provided here for the awarding or the earning of a verified credit for those students now also extends officially to our students that are taking a high school credit bearing course for which a verified credit is an option in our summer 2020 term and then the second group of um the second substantive change that we've

[00:46:46] made is the addition of a new group that would be eligible for accessing that new streamlined locally awarded verified credit process and if you're looking at the document the the easiest place to look is if you go under under the guidance section there's a subheading called eligibility and it's that second bullet so that first bullet were those students that we captured in the first document those students who weren't graduating this year but graduating in an upcoming cohort enrolled in a high school credit bearing course that were eligible for the verified credit but of course the extended school closures affected their ability to earn the

[00:47:22] verified credit but we've also realized that there's again the second group of students who are again graduating in upcoming cohorts so in the 2020-2021 cohort and beyond but that actually already earned a standard credit before the spring of 2020 and so these students who had already taken the coursework had earned their standard credit but were unable to pass the sol which is a first prerequisite to accessing the locally awarded verified credits may have been left out or were left out of the the flexibility that was provided in the original document

[00:47:59] and so we wanted to extend that flexibility knowing that if these students were receiving targeted and sustained remediation or enrolled in a course to prepare for taking the sol course for a second time that these students should also have that the ability to move through the locally awarded verified credits just as their students had that were enrolled in a course in the spring 2020 semester so the the group that worked on this language was very thoughtful and and how they framed the second group of eligibility criteria these students again had to have been in targeted or

[00:48:36] sustained remediation in the spring of 2020 so meaning that you know they were maybe not necessarily enrolled in a course but were receiving remedial services working with a teacher on a regular basis had some sort of structured program and we're preparing to take that test as of spring 2020 or of course there are some course options an example that comes to mind our students that were previously in an algebra one course that you know maybe took it in the fall of 2019 earn their standard credits weren't able to pass the SOL on their

[00:49:12] first attempt but we're in a AFDA or algebra functions and data analysis course in the spring in preparation for taking that test a second time so this document extends the flexibility to those particular students and you'll notice the the highlighted language changes below are really just kind of clarifying this additional eligibility criteria one thing that I should note that for these students who are eligible under that second bullet so had already earned their standard credits they're only able to use this flexibility once so whereas students and who

[00:49:51] were in courses as of spring 2020 may use the locally awarded verified credit for any course in which they could have earned a verified credit in spring the second pathway is there's only an option to use one and as you scroll through again the the pathway for the locally awarded verified credit is expanded for these students and i should mention that the only other item that or one of the ways in which this document kind of supports those students who had previously earned their standard credit is it it doesn't require those students to have earned within a certain

[00:50:26] range so that 375 to 399 on their original standards of learning assessment in order to access the locally awarded verified credit process so just kind of in summation that the for this new category um this document does three things for them um it requires that they don't have to test the second time which is in the the board guidance um then no don't have to score within the certain range the 375 to 399 and then allows them to access the streamlined process for the locally awarded verified credit again this doesn't count towards the cap on locally awarded

[00:51:04] verified credit so any locally or any verified credit earned through through this pathway and through this emergency guidelines wouldn't count towards the cap any verified credit earned outside of that would still apply in the same way that it does in the original guidance but the ones earned through this flexibility do not so with that being said i think i've touched on the highlights and the big substantive changes in this document but i am happy to to entertain any questions or provide any clarification.

[00:51:32] - Any questions? Okay, I guess the request is we adopt these today?

[00:51:47] - Yes, it is. - Okay, is there a motion on this? - I will make a motion that we approve the revised emergency guidelines for locally awarded verified credits for immediate implementation for the superintendent's recommendation. - Thank you. - Second. - Thank you.

[00:52:03] We have a motion and a second, and again, roll call vote. Ms. Atkinson? - Aye. - Dr. Duran? - Aye. Ms. Holton? Aye. Dr. Mann? Aye.

[00:52:18] Dr. Pexton? Aye. Dr. Wilson? Aye. Chair votes aye. Okay. Thank you all very much for that. Thank you so much. We'll move on to item G, first review of the advisory board on teacher education licensure recommendations to approve undergraduate education endorsement programs at Virginia colleges and universities.

[00:52:41] Ms. Pitts? thank you president gecker members of the board and dr lane i will begin by thanking the director of teacher education tara mcdaniel and her team the content specialist in the department of education who reviewed these programs and our colleagues in the state council of higher education for virginia this was truly a team initiative lead led by miss mcdaniel's leadership the 2018 general assembly amended the code of virginia to allow institutions of higher education

[00:53:17] to offer undergraduate degrees and majors in education in response to that legislation colleges and universities were provided timelines to submit undergraduate education programs for approval by the board and for public institutions they also had to receive approval by shift. In 2019, the Board of Education approved the first 53 undergraduate teacher education programs at 15 institutions. In the second phase of

[00:53:53] request, institutions submitted requests in October of 2019, last year, and content specialists conducted a thorough review of the education endorsement programs, verifying that the Board of Education endorsement competencies all had been met. On May 19, 2020, SHEV approved the degrees and majors requested by public institutions for undergraduate education programs. Institutions that are private do not have to have SHEV approval.

[00:54:28] On June 4, 2020, Abtel approved recommendations to the board for the approval of the 71 undergraduate teacher education programs at 15 institutions of higher education listed in your agenda item the superintendent's recommendation is that the board of education waive first review and approve the aptel's recommendations to approve the undergraduate education preparation programs thank you yeah i understand miss

[00:55:02] atkinson is recusing from this entirely is that still right that is correct my husband does a lot of work in the higher ed space and so out of an abundance of caution I am going to recuse myself from this item.

[00:55:18] Okay and that Dr. Wilson will recuse so far as it regards University of Richmond. That is correct. Okay so I don't know if there's any discussion on this the request is to wait first review and to approve if we're going to go that way without discussion at all which is fine the first motion would be all of this except for the excuse me all of it except for the university of richmond and then secondly we would do university of richmond uh so is there any discussion or is

[00:55:53] there a motion or i guess we could do university of richmond first president gecker can i just note that my university is not on this list there so no need for me to recuse if i understand correctly yep all right is there a motion of any sort to wave first review or is there any discussion mr president i'll make a motion to wave first review for all of the schools with the exception of university of richmond okay is there a second i second thank you miss holton all right uh

[00:56:33] dr duran hi miss holton hi dr mann hi dr pexton hi dr wilson i vote yes uh and now a second motion similar except for university of richmond so moved thank you miss holton second thank you dr duran

[00:57:03] okay uh dr duran hi miss holton hi dr man hi dr pexton hi and i vote i also okay covers thank you thank you very much patty yes we are now down i hope to uh presentations assembly tells me i missed something else uh first is our update on early childhood education we are as always delighted to

[00:57:37] have the commonwealth chief school schools of readiness officer jenna conway with us and we look forward to your presentation excellent thank you mr gecker can you hear me i can yes excellent good

morning members of the board our audience is joining us wanted to provide an update a lot of things have occurred since we've lost talk last talk excuse me wanted to give you a sense of the progress we've made even throughout the pandemic then talk about what's on the horizon

[00:58:15] and provide a specific update on some elements of the transition that have been put into motion by the legislation that was passed this year and just letting you know where we at where we are at on that. Next slide, please. One more slide, please. So, wanted to kind of come back to you all with what we've accomplished. Won't read all of the words on the slide here, but I think it's important to communicate that we've continued to make real progress in this space. When we first met, I know one of the concerns that came up was, you know, with all of

[00:58:53] the, you know, kind of very important priorities, particularly those related to equity, which are more now, more important than ever, you know, could we really take on all of this work? And just wanted to let you know, even though it hasn't been sort of necessarily always top of mind, we've continued to make a lot of progress, even with some of the setbacks that have occurred during the pandemic.

[00:59:13] So, you know, very big picture. We got the legislation through that we needed to this year to move everything over. We've been able to work very closely with social services to move kids off wait list into the subsidy program. we received and completed our first year of a federal grant and won a $32.5 million renewal that will really help us sort of build the capacity both at the state level and locally right without requiring kind of state dollars there across the state and we continue to get more and more classroom observations so i know that was a concern how could we move to a place

[00:59:49] where we developed a uniform measurement and improvement system for thousands of classrooms And just want to let you know, in the last year alone, we've conducted more than 3,000 observations of infant, toddler, and preschool classrooms while investing more than $15 million in quality improvement.

[01:00:06] So really, really continuing to make progress. If you'll move to the next slide, please. I specifically wanted to talk about the work that the pilots are doing. So, again, these are these federal dollars that are really enabling us to kind of get on the ground and do the things that we're proposing to do at the state level.

[01:00:25] It also means that, as you sort of say, wow, I'm concerned about as a board taking on this additional responsibility, this broader set of stakeholders, to know that this work is being guided by the field, by the educators down at the ground level.

[01:00:41] And so, again, we've involved nearly 600 sites over the course of the last year across family day homes, child care, and Head Start programs. We've been engaging teachers, right, not only providing observations of teachers, providing them feedback, providing more individualized support and improvement, but also hearing from them.

[01:00:59] So collecting more than 2,000 surveys from teachers, as well as nearly 3,000 surveys from families, right, including kind of sort of understanding how they make choices about early childhood, where the system is serving them well, and where it's fallen short. And then we have also been building a new data portal, Link B5, to make sure as we think about how we would run this system that we have the data we need to be able to kind of come back to you and say, here's what the data tells us about where kids

are being served well, where there are challenges, and how we can set policy based on what's actually happening in the field in Virginia.

[01:01:36] Last but not least, this is sort of hot off the presses. We distributed more than $3 million in funds directly to teachers, so 2,000 teachers across the state, 500 sites. UVA did a random control trial of this work and found unbelievable results.

[01:01:53] So we basically, through this random control trial in Fairfax, were able to keep teachers in classrooms longer, mainly child care and family day home teachers, simply by providing them with $1,500. And really kind of, we saw that kind of really powerful results that we'll all bring back to you at a subsequent board meeting, but again, an example of taking these federal dollars, doing something innovative in Virginia, measuring the results, and then potentially in future years, coming back to you with something that we might want to do at scale, again, driven by the Virginia data.

[01:02:28] So hugely, hugely exciting. The teachers are very positive about this. I say all this to say to kind of for you to feel like, yes, it's good. We're continuing to make progress, but also to know that we are very intently trying to get down to teachers across the system so that when we come back to you, when we set up the advisory council in the next year, when we start to bring big policy proposals to you, to know that we have, you know, for multiple years been trying to hear directly from teachers, directly from families.

[01:02:58] and all of that input, we will help edify and support you as you make these decisions. Next slide, please. You can move to the next slide. So before jumping into where we go from this year up, sorry, I went back, just want to kind of provide a quick snapshot on where we are as it relates to early childhood.

[01:03:22] So high level, again, you know, our preschool and Head Start programs for the most part are closed, and their reopening will be timed with schools. We still have just about 40% of our child care centers are open. A lot of our family day homes are open, and our real challenge right now is supporting this recovery, being really thoughtful about the phase guidance, working closely with Holly and Social Services to make sure that we're not saying one thing for one program that serves four-year-olds and another for another program that serves four-year-olds.

[01:03:54] And, again, I think as we've heard throughout, making sure that we are protecting kids, We are getting kids back into safe environments where they can develop their social-emotional skills. It's really hard to do that in isolation, and we're supporting the economic recovery. We know our families need some place healthy and safe to send their children, and so continuing to work on that.

[01:04:15] Next slide, please. So, as we shift into the 2021 year, I just wanted to kind of touch on three key goals for us as we move forward. One, first and foremost, in response to this pandemic, which has had a really disastrous effect on child care in particular.

[01:04:33] support the reopening kind of across the board working really closely with social services which puts us in a good position when we move over these responsibilities next year which is goal number two transitioning those kind of key functions to from dss to the department of education by july 1st of next year and then continuing to strengthen the system next slide please so as it relates to reopening just to know that i'm working very closely with dr lane holly Leslie, as well as PowerPoints at social services to make sure that we're comprehensively supporting

[01:05:11] the reopening and the recovery of the birth to five system. So whether that's mapping the availability of supply, whether that's thoughtfully using funding, for the first time this year, we're able to

combine state and federal dollars to turn around to the field and say every slot you've asked for as it relates to the Virginia Preschool Initiative, including applying to serve three-year-olds in Virginia Preschool Initiative, we will be able to offer our mixed delivery program that's in private settings. They asked for more money than they received, and we were going to be able to sort of fund them. So again, a lot, you know, every slot that was asked for

[01:05:47] by a Virginia community, public or private, high-quality preschool, we will be able to kind of offer that funding to them this year, and that we think is really important as we support the recovery. And the other last point to note on this is we've done a lot of listening sessions, You know, I've participated in the task force, we've run separate listening sessions, but I probably have heard from upwards of between 150 to 200 direct stakeholders over the course of the last four weeks.

[01:06:13] This is critical as it supports reopening, but it's also critical in terms of really connecting these stakeholders with the Department of Education and the Board of Education. So really seizing on kind of what is otherwise sort of a, you know, a pandemic as an opportunity to begin to develop really deep relationships with not only the schools whom we know well, but the child care, family, day and home sector as well.

[01:06:38] Next slide, please. So not going to read all of the words on this slide, but want you to sort of rest assured that we passed a big piece of legislation this year, you know, and then boom, COVID-19 hit.

[01:06:54] And it felt like that had to be the top priority with supporting our kids, supporting our educators, supporting our families. We are still moving forward. We lost about a month of work, but are still moving forward to transition the different elements. In about two weeks' time, we will move over two key pieces.

[01:07:13] We will move over to the Head Start Collaboration Office. This will not affect the Head Start grantees. those are still federal to local grants, but we will have the main ambassador for Head Start will now become a part of the Department of Education. We will also move over seven positions, six staff who support quality improvement. So when you sort of talk about the challenge of like, how do I measure and support quality across family day home classrooms, child care classrooms, DPI classrooms, Head Start classrooms, we are building a team and are really sort of doubling in size to be able to

[01:07:48] that work this year so we'll kind of and that's also a test run on kind of developing an MOU what the transition looks like figuring out everything from computers to parking but kind of the IT all of the elements that we that was served as a kind of a test run for next year's move of licensing and subsidy and we are we are creating a work group this summer which will include a board of education member to kind of as we start to get into the the bigger challenge of How do we move all of the licensing program?

[01:08:20] How do we move the child care subsidy program, the oversight of that? So we will kind of continue to work on that. But just want you to know, my team is doubling in about two weeks time. So you'll start to hear us talk more about this kind of measurement and improvement, but we are in a good place as it relates to the transition.

[01:08:38] And we are in a good place as it relates to our need to come back to you with a design for the statewide uniform measurement and improvement system in about a year. Next slide, please. and lastly i think this is just you know as i was saying before just letting you know how we're trying to kind of take these disparate pieces you know to bring on more and more communities to receive federal the federal

grant funding to kind of do this work locally to continue to observe classrooms capture that data use that to support educators and to align the professional development

[01:09:13] and supports as well as to deepen family engagement and work kind of locally to support local to make enrollment work easier for foreign families so you don't have to go to five websites to find information you don't have to fill out 16 different applications so this is important as you've heard we're not waiting till everything moves on july 1st of next year to begin this work but really providing funding directly to communities so we can learn from them making sure we're observing classrooms and we're using that data from virginia classrooms to inform our system and that we are keep our educators at the heart of this work so really figuring out how we

[01:09:51] make sure if we say this is how we want to support for example the social emotional needs of our four-year-olds in response to COVID-19 here's how we're adjusting our professional development here that we're doing the same for infant and toddler contracts we're doing the same when we think about our work with our head start ambassador kind of more sort of consistency across the board so we don't have a scenario where one set of educators is getting a lot of supports as we recover from the pandemic and another set of educators is not getting any support. So really trying to kind of balance that work behind the scenes this year so that when we come back to you and say, here's our vision on how we measure and improve every infant, toddler, and preschool classroom that receives

[01:10:31] public dollars, that you know we've been kind of working on that over a longer period of time, and again is informed by our work with our preschool development or PDG B5 pilots. So those are what we're working on so kind of big status update um you know we're continuing to make progress on both the transition on building the foundation for uniform measurement and improvement system on building an early childhood office at the department of education that recognizes and

[01:11:04] connects with the child care family day home head start vpi and early childhood special education that diverse umbrella of constituents and that we are engaging stakeholders every step of the way first focused on on recovery from covet second focused on kind of measurement and support particularly addressing the social emotional needs of our kids and then ultimately making sure we're in a good place to to transition full responsibility by july 1st of next year so let me pause there i know that's a lot of information um and let me see what questions you

[01:11:42] all have are there any questions for jenna i have just one yes dr wilson hi jenna thanks very much for the update um great progress um a question one of your last slot i think talked about um in expanding the pilot to a second cohort any ideas and if i missed it i'm sorry the size of that second cohort how many additional communities are you anticipating yeah so we we have had um we had I think are sort of we got letters of intent from kind of I think 13 to 15 pilots which was sort of

[01:12:18] involved we were aiming initially to get to 40 percent of the state um with with this second group um the the big question we have we've had sort of uh some areas that are more populated so we're kind of we're running that application process right now but we we would like to get to close to half of the state involved in pilots within this next year and where are we right now with the first cohort of communities i can't remember what that number was yeah so that's about 20 of the state so it's 10 pilots but it's 27 jurisdictions one of those jurisdictions is

[01:12:53] fairfax right so that's you know you know it's a pretty significant peak where the where we were really um light and where we've done some intentional outreach is south south side and hampton roads

and so we are crossing our fingers that we that you know those kind of applications will come in and be strong we'll be able to do that and then the other piece is we also we will both bring on new communities and some of our current pilots are going to expand so we have a very strong presence in southwest we have very strong presence in roanoke um i know we've got sort of a strong word of virginia and so kind of continue to expand from those who are doing it is

[01:13:30] also part of our strategy dr wilson thank you any other questions i had a question yes dr man thanks so much, Jenna, for the presentation and for all the work you've been doing to really stay in touch with the stakeholders on the ground and really appreciate what the recovery process has been like related to COVID. And I guess I'm just wondering if there is any perspective around, you know, child care has continued to be open throughout the pandemic and many are transitioning into providing services now. I'm curious what the experience has been with respect to

[01:14:12] just exposure i know those things are not necessarily tracked at the state level but in as much as we're kind of learning internationally what's happening as schools are opening and we're you know serving children in these settings and i think your comment earlier about the importance of not having one set of standards for children that are outside of the k-12 system and a different set for k-12 i'm just curious about what you're you're learning or if there's anything there that will be beneficial as we continue to move through this reopening process?

[01:14:46] Now, that's a great question. I think there's sort of two meta insights based on, again, you know, hearing from hundreds of individuals in a pretty concise time period.

[01:15:01] I think the first of which is adjusting to, you know, this term is overused, but it's probably appropriate adjusting to the the new normal um takes some time right and i really was struck by as i heard from educators and directors who were open and who like kind of figured out you know what practices needed to be put in place how to manage kind of kids and they're both you know behaviors and and you know and and kind of emotions around some of these changes as well as their own educators and and families which was really inspirational to me um because i think these folks had said, you know, we had to be open. We figured out how to do it safely. You know,

[01:15:40] we figured out kind of, you know, how to innovate and be kind of practical and just, you know, this is a changed reality, which is, was, you know, I think it's hard, right? If some of these systems are kind of coming back online to sort of grasp this, how would I do this, right? But it's just, you know, kind of that sort of sense of like, you know, you make the changes you put in place, you know, each week it gets easier, right? And so those folks who've been open the duration are really in a group, right?

[01:16:05] And I know that that's something I think is important as we support school reopening and really encouraging folks to kind of get back and just, you know, it can get easier over time as you're doing this and sort of just adopting, right? It's hard to do it sometimes conceptually. You just have to do it practically. The second key piece is it's been huge for kids.

[01:16:24] So, you know, I think we've tried to really say this is not, we're not opening childcare, you know, because we need sort of economic recovery, right? And the sort of the key thing that our child care educators care about, right, is the kids that they serve and the families that they serve.

[01:16:43] And when we talk to everybody from the pediatrician who's had her kid in the system the whole time to the, you know, the essential worker who's, you know, the janitor or working in sort of

grocery or retail, like it's been huge for them, but it's been even more huge for their kids in terms of having a healthy, safe, consistent place to go to.

[01:17:03] And so really thinking about kind of the social, emotional needs of kids. And even if they have to wear a mask, even if it is a smaller group, even if we're sort of telling the four-year-olds not to touch and that would be their preference, like I don't think we should sort of, you know, dismiss the power of just getting kids back around other kids.

[01:17:24] And so, you know, particularly for the youngers, right? I mean, I think that's what I when I've had conversations and really well-intentioned conversations with closest even childcare centers that remain closed and they said, but you know, if we take, if you have to make them wear a mask or if you don't let kids touch, like you're basically going to cause harm.

[01:17:40] And I can understand the emotions behind that, but if that's weighed against an alternative of isolation, right, if that's compared to, you know, a kid having to bounce from house to house to house or not having stable experiences or not having a kind of an educator who is intent on creating, you know, a loving relationship, like, I'm just not sure.

[01:18:01] So I think that's really important. And I will jump off this meeting and go to a webinar with our VPI and early childhood special education. We're obsessed with all of the details around the recovery plan, and we need to be to keep kids safe. But the true north for me is if we can get our four-year-olds back, if we can get our three-year-olds back and our infants and toddlers, what child care has shown us over the last 12 weeks is that is huge for kids.

[01:18:24] and they will take some of the compromises they wear a mask and pretend to be a superhero they'll deal with less touching you took the soft toys out of the classroom right there are new protocols to follow but just being around other kids and being around you know the adults who want to support their learning development is huge and is just so exciting to see that possibility and with every center that comes back on that opens up that possibility for more more more kids and more families yes thank you great presentation Jenna and amazing work and where we continue the Commonwealth continues to be blessed to

[01:19:03] have you two questions related to the short-term challenges one is are you concerned about losing providers to the pandemic that we will have folks who won't ever be able to come back online and a second question is recognizing that more and more parents for more and more parents child care will become essential as the economy reopens are we satisfied that the and this may

[01:19:42] interact with the first question but are we satisfied that the child care community will be able to meet the the custodial needs of families and and in fact maybe expanded needs if the public schools are not able to open fully as economy opens ahead of schools what's going to happen to all these kids i'm worried that they're going to end up in in inadequate care situations no those are are both incredibly important questions and ones that

[01:20:18] have have kept us up um for most of the the last 12 weeks you know our first answer i think is just really careful monitoring and kind of two ways sort of one is looking at the data on reopening and working really closely with child care aware to track community by community sort of where there is um where there is you know enough capacity and where there is inadequate capacity and that you know

continues to move almost by the week in terms of what's happening locally um as it relates to to both the public health crisis and the economic recovery.

[01:20:54] And it is, you know, and kind of keeping sort of abreast of that is important. I think it's also critical sort of anecdotally, and so kind of working with the Early Childhood Foundation and with a lot of the Smart Beginnings, I participate in a lot of calls locally around where folks are at and making sure that conversations are happening.

[01:21:15] So that if, you know, somebody is about to bring a whole bunch of folks back into the office, like the major employer community, that they're kind of checking with child care first and evaluating that capacity. And anything we're trying to broker right now, getting school superintendents to be talking with child care, is they're thinking about schedules, right, because you don't want them to come up with half time.

[01:21:36] K-12 remains the biggest provider of child care in the Commonwealth, right? I mean, we don't talk about that, but it is true in terms of kids, particularly age 4 to 12. And so trying to kind of broker those conversations. And then I think looking at where there are resources to provide and making sure that we are getting dollars out the door to programs.

[01:22:00] We don't know how many are not going to come back. I think we still have a lot of folks still on kind of using unemployment, unfortunately, the bailout for child care. We still have folks receiving the PPP. We still have a lot of unemployed adults in the system, right?

[01:22:18] And so as those numbers shift, I think we sort of will hit one of those benchmarks end of July. We'll see the school reopening August. And so trying to kind of continue to evaluate, you know, where is it that we need, you know, more resources. We are working closely with social services and hope to get all of the $70 million that was dedicated to childcare out the door by September, right?

[01:22:39] Really sort of said, ask for needed in terms of getting out there. But I think there... you know, the kind of the test will really be this fall as schools return and whether their, you know, parents want the care, whether or not, you know, employers are going to sort of force folks to come back in.

[01:22:58] um it is it is a precarious balance and it is it's the one thing that this this this crisis has revealed is this is not you know this this the early sort of the child care aspect of the early childhood sector you know is is the most fragile kind of part right in a way that like head start you know they've been able to kind of keep those resources flowing those teachers paid same is true for um early childhood special education and for vpi and child care is much more fragile um and so we just will have to continue to monitor and i think as as as needed if if more resources are needed to continue to be able to advocate to the federal government for

[01:23:36] that okay thank you very much jenna for being with us it's always informative and it's you know clearly important to where commonwealth's going and to where this board is going so we appreciate i think there's one more question from dr dron oh i missed that i'm sorry francisco no problem thank you first jenna i just want to thank you for the comprehensive update and overview what my ears were ringing with in a positive way was the focus on building capacity and really thinking about how we're supporting teachers and assistants across not just in school-based

[01:24:12] settings or particularly non-school-based settings and thinking about i loved your reference to mental health and the instructional standards that we're working towards getting some level that we can

expect that all students will have access to and so i would love not right now you're welcome to comment now but in future updates i would love to understand a little bit more to expound upon what that really looks like what are the ways that we are able to reach success in that and then what are some of the challenges you're facing as you're working through that so if you'd like to comment briefly on that that's fine i didn't mean to have a short answer at the moment but that is something i'm very interested in and i'm glad to see that is an area of direction

[01:24:51] that you've outlined for us and look forward to learning much more about that i think it's a missing piece for us to ensure true equity for students to have a consistent um baseline that everyone should have in all of our services whether they're school-based or not so thank you again and comment but future details sure very very brief um i will say that we are um really focused on the social emotional first right and i think the sort of simplest way to describe that is you know really working with our educators, as we've heard from our child care folks who either remained open or are coming back online, you know, is the kids are not okay when they first come back, right? And

[01:25:30] that doesn't always manifest in, hey, I'm saying, oh, hey, I'm Jen and I'm not okay today, right? It manifests in tantrums, it manifests in not following rules and a whole set of disruptive behaviors, right? And really making sure that, you know, we don't sort of add to the trauma by coming you know sort of strong on discipline and sort of instead understand that this is just you know it's been in such a shock and trauma to the system right and sort of how do we kind of meet kids where they are and how do we make sure we support educators right and educators to support families is sort of our sort of you know our obsession the second piece and we've we have

[01:26:05] some partners who use a version of vkrp right particularly the behavior scales and they've seen even in programs that have remained open you know just what has happened societally what has happened to families has caused serious regression and they have data to sort of to demonstrate that so we are working really carefully and thoughtfully with our divisions we think it's really important to do an evaluation of behavior skills for everybody kind of entering the system this year we know we don't want it to be sort of perceived as like quote unquote testing but But I think understanding the magnitude of the kind of social-emotional response will be critical.

[01:26:45] And then making sure that we can then turn around and provide our preschool teachers and our kindergarten teachers and, you know, as well as our early elementary teachers with the resources to support that is going to be critical. But based on the data I've seen thus far, it's pretty damning, right, that just, it's just, you know, kids may not be the most visible victims of this pandemic.

[01:27:07] But when you look at their behaviors, like they are clearly affected and the wrong way, the wrong way to respond to those behaviors is with sort of discipline and cracking down, right? The right way is to really sort of focus on love and support and helping kids, you know, kind of adjust back to the classroom to deal with the changes, whether that's, you know, wearing the mask or keeping distant and making sure that we're really supporting our educators and our families to do that.

[01:27:36] it requires all of us to operate a little differently and so we are trying to anticipate that and support the field and then i'll i'll bring you more dr durham when we sort of get you know those results from more of the state and we can talk in more detail about how we will be supporting social emotional mental health thank you i appreciate that okay thank you thank you again all right we will move on to item

i uh we are delighted always delighted to have our friends from the curry school with us uh dr miller will give a presentation i warn you that he is a

[01:28:09] performance artist and never likes to be tethered to his computer. So, Luke, welcome and thank you for being with us. Thank you, President Gecker and the other members of the board and Dr. Lane for inviting me here today to give you an update on the findings that we have from the working condition survey that we conducted a little over a year ago in all public schools in the state. We, at the same time did a smaller scale school climate survey. Those results are at the end of this slide

[01:28:46] deck that I won't take time to discuss here today. Go next slide, Emily. So we have been spending the last year spending time getting the results of this survey out to key stakeholders, doing some additional analyses of these data to prevent the thing that we don't want is send out the signal to those folks who took time to complete the survey that this was just an administrative burden that their efforts went into this big black hole. So one thing we did right away was return summary reports back to

[01:29:24] divisions and schools that summarize their folks in their schools and divisions responses to the to the survey questions we also produce reports that provided that facilitate facilitated comparisons across schools within a division across divisions and regions within the state next but of course there's a whole lot more that whoops i've got some uh to go back yeah thank you uh so what i want to do today is move the next step beyond uh that and uh answer provide you some with some findings on two research questions that take us a little bit deeper into

[01:30:03] the working conditions data particularly focused on teacher perceptions of their working conditions understanding how those perceptions vary across different teacher and school groups and then bringing those perceptions looking at those to see how they relate to teacher job satisfaction and their intentions of to remain at their current school eventually we'll be able to look at how school level perceptions of working conditions relate to actual turnover of teachers, but the turnover data won't be available until September at the earliest. Next slide, please. So again,

[01:30:41] we surveyed all regular public schools in the state. 93% of them participated. There were 79 divisions where all the schools in that division participated, and there were another 17. There were 17 that had less than 75% of schools participating. We had a little over 54,000 individual teachers respond. That's 62% of all teachers in the regular public schools. If you look at just the teachers in the schools that participate, that's a 67% response rate. Those are respectable response rates. We'd love for them to be higher. We're going to aim for that in the next round of this,

[01:31:18] but we were fairly pleased with that. On the staff survey, next Emily, just to bring up the the next bit of the slide, thanks. We had 91% of schools participating there. We had a little over 19,500 surveys come in.

[01:31:35] We can't produce a response rate for this because there is no central repository of the total number of staff in schools. There was also quite a bit of variation across individual schools in who on their staff, their non-teaching staff, they invited to take the survey.

[01:31:54] Some schools invited administrative secretaries and administrative assistants, bus drivers, custodians, cafeteria workers, but that was not universal across the school. Next slide, please. So here are the statewide results, which have been out online for a while now.

[01:32:14] So these are the individual measures that came from the working condition surveys. We have the mean standard deviation, the percent negative for the teachers and for the staff survey. The responses to these questions were all on a six point scale, from strongly disagree to a strongly agree.

[01:32:31] If you look down the means on both teachers and staff, you'll see that all of those means are above 3.5, which is the dividing line between a disagree response and an agree response. So overall, teachers and staff feel positively about their working conditions.

[01:32:48] However, if you look at the percent negative, you can see that on some of these measures, there are a substantial share of teachers and staff that disagree that have a negative perception of their working conditions. For example, over a quarter percent of teachers felt negatively about the way that student behavior was managed in their school.

[01:33:10] Next slide, please. So this first research question, I want to, again, take those teacher perceptions and see how they differ across observable characteristics of teachers and schools. Next slide. Next slide.

[01:33:25] So for this we are-- whoops, sorry. Yeah, thanks, Emily. So we have taken those individual measures of working conditions. And for the ease of presentation in this slide, I'm going to be talking about the aggregate measure, which is the average of those with the exception of prevalence of bullying, which didn't load on to the factor with all the other measures of working conditions.

[01:33:46] I'm going to standardize that so I can talk about differences across teacher and subgroups in terms of effect sizes, where just sort of benchmark your understanding of those. If we have a difference of an effect size of 0.8 or higher, that's a large effect size.

[01:34:03] Between 0.5 and below 0.8 is a moderate effect size. Between 0.2 and below 0.5 is small. Anything below 0.2 is trivial. Teacher groups, the survey captured information on their gender. You see 83% of respondents were female.

[01:34:21] that's fairly in line with the actual gender breakdown of teacher workforce in Virginia. We have race and ethnicity information, 80% of respondents were white, 8% black, 4% Hispanic. Again, fairly in line with what we know of the overall teacher workforce in Virginia.

[01:34:36] We also captured information on subject and school, the years that they've been, the number of years they've been at their school, 36% of teachers who responded were in their first to third year at their school, 8% had been at that current school for more than 20 years.

[01:34:53] I'm also gonna present results where I break schools into quintiles based on the percent of their student body that is minority and the percent of their student body that are economically disadvantaged.

[01:35:10] I'll also show you differences across school level and community type. Next slide, please. So when I'm looking at teacher characteristics, I'm actually comparing teachers within the same school. The vast majority of the variation in these measures rest between teachers within the same school with about 15 to 20% being between schools.

[01:35:31] So when you look at differences across gender within the same school, males have viewed their working conditions more positive than the females, but the difference is relatively trivial. When you look at teachers' differences perceptions of their overall working conditions by race within the same school

black teachers feel more positively than white teachers now again the zero line here is the average perceptions that's not not differentiating between positive and negative as you saw in the first summary slide the means and all of these

[01:36:05] are in the four to five range so black and that's perfect so when we look at differences by subjects you see that CTE teachers uh and health PE teachers feel the most positively about their working conditions whereas elementary teachers ELA and history and social studies teachers feel the least positively about theirs and then with the years that current uh years of the teacher has been at the current school this probably shouldn't surprise you that the people who are relatively new uh have the most positive views the people who have been there for a while

[01:36:43] have a better sense of how things are going how they line up with what they would like to see are have the least positive views next slide please so some of the more um stark differences were when we look at uh differences in teacher perceptions across types of schools so on the left i have again broken the schools down by quintile of their student body that are minority students such that q1 has a lowest share the lowest concentration and q4 has the highest concentration you see that as the percent, the concentration of minority students in the school increases,

[01:37:20] teacher perceptions decrease. The difference between Q1 and Q4 is in that small effect size range of 0.229. The same pattern we see in terms of the concentration of economically disadvantaged students at a school. As the concentration increases, the teacher perceptions decrease such that the difference between the first quintile and either the third quintile or the fourth quintile is above that 0.2 threshold for a small effect size difference. Next slide please. So here

[01:37:59] on the left we've got differences by school level. High school teachers feel least positively about their working conditions. Elementary teachers feel the most positive. That difference is 0.211 again in that small effect size difference teachers in the few schools that are in the state that are combined these are the k pre-k to eight schools uh feel similarly about their working conditions to elementary teachers and we look across uh community type rural town suburb city the city teachers the teachers who are teaching in city schools that um are uh feel the least positive

[01:38:38] about their working conditions and suburban teachers uh feel the most positively next slide All right, so now we want to move to that next step. So if you remember the working condition survey was mandated by the legislature and that authorizing legislation specifically states they want to know how working conditions differ across states and how they then influence teacher retention and student achievement. You think job satisfaction is going to be intimate related to both of those outcomes. So here we're going to be looking at job satisfaction and their intentions

[01:39:15] or stated intentions to remain at that school. Next slide, please. So the job satisfaction is coming from a single question on the survey. This is common across many working condition surveys out there. The question is overall, or the statement is overall, my school is a good place to work and learn. You see that 71% of respondents either agree or strongly agree with that statement.

[01:39:40] 7% either disagree or strongly disagree. Next, bring up the next bit of data. The career intention is coming from a question where we ask them, please tell us which of the following best describe your immediate professional plans. If you hit the next twice, we can bring up the rest of this slide. And one more time. Perfect. Thank you. So, whoops, go back. Thanks. So from these um eight responses you see that 82 percent of teachers intend to return to their school

[01:40:15] so that would have been this current school year uh and eight percent said that they intend to remain a teacher in schools in virginia but either in a different school in their division or in a different division and then uh excuse me 10 uh intend to exit the teaching working force the public school teaching working force in virginia this is in line with the retention the actual retention rates that we observed in the 16-17 school year next slide please so here uh to begin

[01:40:50] answering this question i am just showing you the average responses to that aggregate working conditions measure by the different levels of job satisfaction in the first line of data and then by the different um career intentions in the second line of data you see that as job satisfaction declines so does perceptions of their working conditions when you look at career plans the teachers who say that they intend to return the following year to their same school view their their working conditions more positively than those who don't intend to return to that school

[01:41:26] next slide so of course i just showed you that there's differences in perceptions across teacher characteristics there's difference in perceptions of working conditions across school characteristics So now, I'm going to bring all of this together in a statistical model that controls for those differences across respondents. I'm also implementing a correction for common sense bias. If teachers are unsatisfied with their job, then they may feel an incentive to or need to

[01:42:01] justify that lack of satisfaction by indicating perceptions of the working conditions that are more negative than they actually are you could also look at this with in terms of career path decisions where if a teacher intends knows they're going to need to stay at their school for whatever reason the following year they may justify that by providing us information perceptions of their working conditions that are more positive the simple solution to this is just instead of looking at an individual's response perception on their job satisfaction and career intention to instead take the average of all their peers at their school and use that. Next slide,

[01:42:41] please. So here is a basic OLS regression. Again, this is just predicting that job satisfaction, the standardized version of that, against teacher characteristics, school characteristics, and then this aggregate measure. Next slide. With the career plans, you remember each teacher makes one of three, indicated one of three choices, our three intentions: to stay, to move, or to exit so here i'm going to run a multinomial logit model that is comparing how when i change

[01:43:17] the level of working conditions how does an individual's relative probability of moving versus staying and then exit versus saying changing i can then bring all that together say okay and one standard deviation increase in working conditions has this percentage change on their probability of staying at their same school. Next slide. So here's the punchline from those studies or from those analyses, from those statistical models. So if I compare two teachers that look the same in similar schools, but one of those schools has working conditions

[01:43:53] that are one standard deviation higher than the other, the job satisfaction for that teacher in the school with higher working conditions, more positive working conditions, is 0.784 standard standard deviations higher that's just that's almost into that large effect size range that I talked about earlier shifting to the career plans again comparing two teachers who look similar who are in similar looking schools but one of those schools has an aggregate working

[01:44:28] conditions viewpoint one standard deviation higher than the other but that teacher in the higher perceived working condition school is 73.4 percentage point of percent less likely to move and 46.1

percent less likely to exit so if you think about this as one of those balloons that people make balloon animals out if i've squeezed the section that is moving and i've squeezed the section that is exiting then the stay section must be blowing up and in fact one standard deviation

[01:45:02] higher perceived working conditions increases the probability that a teacher stays at their school by 13.2%. So these are large associations. So yep, next slide's perfect. So where do we, where are we going from here? So first there's additional analyses that we have done and presented online and additional analyses that are moving, that are currently being done on the 2019 data. I should have thanked before when I started that all of this work could never have been done

[01:45:35] without the stellar involvement of Dr. Jennifer Pibarena and Maribel Samri, who were involved in the design of these surveys, the execution, and thinking through these analyses. That team is reassembled to prepare for the 2021 administration of this survey, which is going to be better than And the first, one reason is that VDOE has engaged and created a strong collaboration with DCGS, which has been doing a school climate survey for years now.

[01:46:09] These will be integrated, so schools will receive one request from the state that covers both of these surveys. There's a survey that the Virginia Department of Health also does that's being incorporated in this single effort as well. So again, the plan is to, right now, to do these surveys in January and March of 2021.

[01:46:31] All licensed personnel in all schools will be asked to complete the survey, and students in middle schools will also be able to ask to complete the survey. Then after the next year, the state will shift back to this every other year rotation, where in 2022, high schools will be the focus of the survey, licensed personnel and students.

[01:46:52] 2023, it will be elementary and middle school personnel asked to take the survey and then middle school students will be asked to take the survey. There is no plan to survey elementary school students. The client will still do those quick turnaround reports to get the data back out to individuals who have some power to move, to lead efforts to try to shift or maintain working conditions.

[01:47:19] I also want to point out that the VDOE's work to this point on working condition surveys have been funded through research grants that we, in partnership with UVA and VDOE, have been able to receive from IES.

[01:47:35] One is ending this month, but luckily we were fortunate to craft a winning proposal for another round of funding of $1.4 million to support the 2021 administration, plus some additional data collection.

[01:47:51] So you think about what the survey is doing, it's giving us a description of how teachers perceive their working conditions. We can use that to look at variation and relationships to other things. But the survey just is not well-suited to do is to tell us why teachers feel the way they feel.

[01:48:09] So we have in '21-'22, that school year, the plan is to go out, do interviews with teachers, principals, and division officials, where the big goal there is to try to understand from them what they see as the factors that either enable or hinder the provision of supporting teaching working conditions another key so uh thing that we're gonna be looking at uh with this new grant is uh the local use of the survey data right the the idea the hope here is that this is aware raises awareness um and then motivates uh

[01:48:44] efforts to uh to move the needle on some of these given the known importance that working conditions play to uh to recruiting uh highly effective teachers and then the role that those teachers have on student achievement uh so that uh that is what i wanted uh to cover today uh in my limited time i probably could have talked for two hours and again there's more information in the rest of the slide deck on on the school climate survey and i can take any questions that anyone are there any

[01:49:18] questions first and then we'll i have one yes um dr miller thanks very much for the overview i have to say that when you were getting into standard deviations and all that my head almost exploded but that's another story um i do have a question about um one of your early slides and we don't need to go back to it but um the item on management of student behavior and the 26 percent negative perception of how that and so my question is was the do we know if the response was based on a

[01:49:54] teacher's skill set in classroom management or was it related to how perhaps administration handles student behavior once it's out of the classroom? - So the questions were all asking about management in the school.

[01:50:12] - Okay. - So they were not targeted to inside or outside the classroom. - Okay, great, thank you. - Any other questions?

[01:50:28] I will say, Dr. Wilson, if you had taken econometrics, had that been required, the standard deviation question would not have bothered you one bit. - And in full disclosure, Mr. Gecker, in my preparation program, I took zero economics courses.

[01:50:46] - We're gonna have to do something about this. - Well, yeah, it's on my list. - Requirement for the board. - That's right. - Anybody else? I will say there's a lot here, but I was particularly pleased that in the next rendition, you're gonna do interviews because if perception, for example, is just completely correlated to the composition of the student body, which there seemed to be some correlation there.

[01:51:19] It doesn't really help in terms of what we do about it. And so the idea of getting to, frankly, the issues of how close are the perceptions to the reality and how do we meaningfully change those perceptions is I think gonna be important for us going forward.

[01:51:38] - I totally agree. I mean, the ability to first understand the lay of the land is important, but we don't want to stop there. And with this, the idea with those interviews is to help move this conversation in the Commonwealth to the next step.

[01:51:54] Okay, fine. So we understand more what the perceptions are, how they vary, what can we do to try to move things forward on this? And so the hope is that from those, we can identify some of those factors, and then we We can do some statistical examination of them to see how those play out statewide.

[01:52:17] And then perhaps go after some additional funding to start trying to develop or implement some interventions that have already been done in the field to see if they work here in Virginia. Are you also going to do any study of the perception that teachers have of the work environment and compare that to the uh perception that their supervisors have of their ability to do the work in other words part of this is geared toward retaining people right how do we improve conditions so that we retain workers we have the shortage and you know 10 turnover is significant

[01:52:53] uh but if the people who have got the worst perceptions are also those people who are not doing the job as well, perhaps some of those we really just want to leave. Go ahead. So you touch on a very

important point that I think the goal should not be 100% teacher retention.

[01:53:15] You know, first, I mean, even if you check out the people who retired, that's just, that isn't, the goal should be 100% retention of teachers who are effective or we believe are on their way to becoming effective, and then 100% attrition of teachers who are ineffective and we don't believe can become effective.

[01:53:33] Are we dovetailing this at all with any data at the individual level about teacher effectiveness? So there are no plans for that. The reason for that is the lack of data on that. I thought you guys were working on measures of teacher effectiveness in one of our last conversations.

[01:53:52] So there have been conversations, lots of conversations on that. How do we get that information um uh from either individual divisions or from through the state the best we can do right now with state-level data is look at teacher qualifications that have um small relationships with other measures of effectiveness but this whole the other point that you're getting at is this what is our definition of effectiveness and how once we have that definition how do we

[01:54:28] collect data how do we measure that so uh mr president may i ask a question of course yeah it's often yeah dr miller thank you for uh all this great work it really is incredibly valuable and i'm going to look at the slides on the climate survey as well uh uh um my the my big picture question is what what does this work tell us about our that's relevant to our concern and our goal

[01:55:01] of getting the best teachers to the students who need them the most and in particular students in high minority high low income schools and and what might we expect in the next rounds of work that might be relevant to that or how can you how can we help you tailor future work to help us answer that question so one of the additional bits of

[01:55:33] analysis that I am working on gets directly at this. So there are lots of information, lots of sites out there that show that teacher retention is lower in schools that have higher concentrations of minority and disadvantaged students. However, in Virginia with these data, just like we have seen in other states with their working condition survey, that if you run that model where you are predicting retention, you see that, yes, retention is predicted to be lower in schools with these

[01:56:08] serving these higher needs student populations. But once you then add into that model working conditions and you're holding the working conditions constant across school, the predictive power of those student body characteristics on retention attenuates, either goes to zero or it's much closer to zero. That's suggesting, it doesn't prove, but what it suggests, especially the fact that we're seeing this over many different jurisdictions is that it is the working conditions in those schools that serve those higher needs student populations that is

[01:56:43] what is contributing more to teacher turnover in those schools rather than teachers not wanting to teach those types of students so what so we are pushing on that to say okay well are there certain working conditions that maybe are more positively correlated with teacher retention decisions in schools that serve more of these higher-need students than in the lower-need students.

[01:57:11] That is something we are working on right now with our current data. The new grant, again, which is leveraging the 2021 survey plus the interview data, is also going to be looking at the role of teacher working conditions in retaining teachers in rural schools who don't come from a rural background. There's lots of research out there, there's a fair number of research out there that suggests

that teachers who come from away into rural communities are less likely to remain there than our teachers who are from that community or from similar communities.

[01:57:50] There's also a study that is being led by my colleague Rachel White at Old Dominion where she's really interested in how the working conditions interact with teachers of English learners and how that seems to be contributing to the achievement of English language learners. So, if I may ask a follow-up, can we use this data to help find and examine

[01:58:25] further the schools that are working so so beating the odds in other words schools that despite being high poverty high minority have teachers who find the working conditions satisfactory and then can we go in and zero in on those schools and divisions and say okay what are they doing i mean is it salary is it support is it what that that's what are they doing to create more more satisfaction in these challenging environments? And is your data, you know, specific enough that it could help

[01:59:01] us find some of those found models, so to speak? So it's almost like you read our proposal, Ms. Hulton, and that is the, that, so in the new, with the new grant money, one of the things we are wanting to do is to develop profiles of working conditions within schools. So in this analysis that I showed you I just took a simple average of the measures that means that you could have two schools that have the same number on that aggregate you know once you average their eight

[01:59:37] measures together they come up with the same number but how those individual measures look across the two schools could be very different so there's a another statistical technique called latent profile analysis that the what the nice thing about that is it will look at the how these individual dimensions of working conditions look on the ground in the context of schools and and identify profiles of them so you know these are the schools that are really high on these several dimensions they're sort of uh in the middle of the group on these and then low on these others

[02:00:15] the idea so we'll create these profiles each school will be assigned to a profile that again characterizes their overall working conditions context for teachers and staff and then we will use those profiles to identify schools in which we want to interview principals and teachers and we will stratify those by saying okay which are the schools that have high levels of low high levels of student achievement versus low levels of student achievement or really we're going to be

[02:00:48] looking at achievement opportunity gaps between the achieve the performance of white students and performance of non-white students with the idea being that we will be able to identify those schools that you could say are doing better than what one would expect given their context of the community that they serve and try to hopefully from them understand how what what enabled them to provide those supportive working conditions whereas a school that looks similar to them

[02:01:22] wasn't able to okay thank you yeah thank you very much uh it is as i said at the beginning very good to see you again i hope we have an opportunity to do it in person soon so thanks thank you very much okay uh we have two i guess uh written reports uh and now we'll move on to discussion of current issues by board of ed members uh there's a couple things i wanted to

[02:01:56] cover in this uh the first though is to take just a brief minute and to give diane if she wants it a brief moment to uh you know make some comments as mentioned coming in this will be ms atkinson's the last meeting with the board uh for no reason other than statutorily she's not allowed to serve another

term. My understanding is you were first appointed by Governor Gilmore in 2001, then by Governor McDonnell in 2012, and Governor McAuliffe in 2016. You worked for the department,

[02:02:32] you have taught, and as I said coming into the meeting, you are a complete source of information and institutional history with regard to the education system and the commonwealth, and you have generously shared that information and institutional knowledge with all of us at various times me in particular i'll say when i first joined the board in 2016 and began going to the accreditation meetings uh which you ran i was thinking what am i doing here i have no idea

[02:03:08] what any of this is but uh over time and you know with your guidance and help uh not only on accreditation issues but on frankly everything to do with education in the state uh you know i think we've moved a bunch of things forward uh none of it would have happened without you being there and your generosity of time and friendship so i don't know if you have any desire to say anything uh since i'm facing here a screen that just says diane atkinson as opposed to the pictures uh

[02:03:42] if you would like to you know we'd love to hear from you diane i don't know why my video is off let me see if i somehow turned it off i don't know how to turn it back on to be honest bottom left of the screen perhaps well i'm looking um there we go i don't know maybe it was a fat finger hitting me and i hit i stopped my video but anyways um that's that all tells you my expertise in the technology but anyways um i know there will be an opportunity in the future so i'll

[02:04:22] keep my remarks fairly brief but the first thing i want to say is what an honor and a privilege i have felt to have been able to serve on the board of education and especially with each of my colleagues on the board in the you know my first stint on the board was just a couple months and so i sort of put that to the side but this last stint has been eight plus years and i've had the privilege of serving along some incredible individuals and I count all of you amongst them.

[02:05:00] It's amazing how all our different experiences really do help to create a board that is thoughtful, looks at our issues from so many different perspectives, is willing to hear from the public willing to engage the public um and um and then uh do our responsibility in making the decisions um it has been an honor to work on so many issues i'm so proud of the work that has been

[02:05:39] done in these past eight years um and as i look forward to the challenges that the board has in the year to come especially in light of what's happening in our country right now um both the pandemic and the issue of equity and race um i am so confident that the members that are on this board will serve us so well going down that path in the year ahead and so even i am so sad to leave but i am so happy to know that um the board will will be able to function so well with

[02:06:18] my with my colleagues and then um for the department you know i i spent 15 years at the agency and then took a big break before i came back on the board and you know what i knew when I worked at the agency was how professional and how heartfelt each person was for the students in this commonwealth. And my eight years on the board have reiterated that. The work that we do

[02:06:53] as a board member and the work that I did as, you know, chairing the committee on accreditation, accountability um really was so facilitated by the hard work of so many people at the agency and you know when i was there we probably had double the number of staff um there's half the staff but more of the work more work than there was when i was there and so um just to acknowledge the depth of um appreciation i have for the folks at the agency and then superintendents

[02:07:30] i have gone through if i think about how many superintendents in in my 15 years there were quite a few and then in my years on the board um i've been honored to serve with all of them and i said this to you the other day dr lane um you know i i am a woman of great faith and there is a provision in the book of ruth that talks about her placement in a time where where it it needed to be. And I truly, truly believe that you are where you are right now, because we need

[02:08:06] your leadership through what is happening here. And so I so thank you for that leadership. And then the final comment I want to make is to the public who I've been seeing so greatly. I really have enjoyed getting to know so many different stakeholders. You help us make that work. You help us do this work and and so appreciate your willingness to come listen to us share your thoughts with us and really help us create a better product and so um i ask that you continue

[02:08:41] and maybe i'll be one of those stakeholders out and out in that audience in the future so watch out but anyway so i i am so sad to leave but so appreciate all of you and um i think i better not any more before i get just a little bit too choked up so thank you thank you and we will have a chance as i said to do this in person i hope soon uh so we can do this the right way i will say you know when they asked us what the qualifications are the person to replace you i think the answer is somebody will actually read the regs i'm not sure we have anybody else on the board who is going to

[02:09:20] uh take the time to do what you have done for us there okay so you've identified me as a nerd i know no it's a very positive thing in my world very very positive thing so thank you ah which seems inadequate but we keep going uh dr lane we had a lot of public comment and a lot of it was centered around reopening of schools etc as you know this board has very little to do with that topic but i know you've had a chance to review a fair amount of public comment do you

[02:09:57] mind addressing where we are and uh you know what you see happening going forward yes and uh and certainly before i do that again from the agency standpoint diane we want to thank you as well for serving on the board and just personally i want to thank you for the guidance i will say there are many meetings we sit in and you are the barometer for the quality and depth of what we write we say well, when Diane Atkinson reads this, what is she going to say? And I'm still going to keep saying that even if you're gone because I think that's the level of quality that we will always expect

[02:10:34] moving forward. And so just thank you again for everything. Mr. Gecker, I have a PowerPoint that I can do in about five minutes that really summarizes this thing, or I can speak off the cuff. do you mind if i use the powerpoint is that okay let's do it the way you're comfortable james okay well emily why don't we pull that up uh and so uh obviously uh we can pass the title slide but the

[02:11:14] this is the presentation that was kind of the backbone of what we used when we talked about this at the governor's briefing last week uh the governor did uh release this information on tuesday of last week and uh uh and you know essentially the theme here is that schools will be open but instruction uh very well will look uh different and i'll i'll tell you the reasons why as we move through the slides but um the one of the key components is that we will require

[02:11:42] sorry my doorbell running now my dog is barking sorry uh right it scared away my cat thank you yeah the uh but emily if you'll go back i was not quite finished with that last slide um so we are requiring new instruction as we move forward uh and i think the the biggest difference that we should share is that uh whereas we closed schools under an executive order

[02:12:17] we're opening schools under guidance and that's uh that's a distinction that's important but but what we are doing is when we closed schools we allowed schools to focus on continuity of learning and just you know caring for students and all of that which is still important but we because we're open new instruction and moving forward on students academic careers is going to be required but some of that will happen in person and some of that will take place via remote learning so so now emily i'll uh take this to the next slide and so the plan does align to the governor's

[02:12:52] forward virginia blueprint so as a community moves to a certain phase the school community moves with that as of last friday all of virginia is in phase two and the governor's been talking about phase three coming in the near future. It does scale up in-person instruction. It does focus on health, social, emotional, and physical well-being of both students and staff. But probably the most unique part about Virginia's plan is that it does prioritize equity and allows some of the students that were struggling the most with remote learning to come back in person the soonest. On the next

[02:13:30] slide, here is the highest level summary of our three-phase plan. I'll go into a little bit more depth on each piece but phase one which is essentially behind us special education programs and child care for working families could be done in person in phase two you keep those options plus you can now serve preschool through third grade students english learners and do summer camps for students of any age we've gotten a lot of questions around why maybe preschool through third grade first and frankly we had the most concerns that our earliest learners were not able to access the remote learnings as successfully as some of our our older students and we wanted to get

[02:14:08] uh them in-person services the the fastest and by the time we get to phase three which again should should be well before the beginning of the next school year uh if you're looking at the data trends today the governor has not announced any specific dates but now all students may be accommodated in person but uh strict social distancing measures are recommended and i'll highlight those in a moment and then we do have a little bit of guidance for beyond phase three there will be a time that every student will be back every day in our recommendations the the plan does

[02:14:42] allow maximum flexibility so you've gotten a lot of questions from parents some will say we think that your guidance is not stringent enough and you'll hear from other parents that will say we think that your your guidance is too stringent and so school divisions can always be more stringent than the guidance, but they are because this is guidance. School divisions may deviate from our guidance and put their own mitigation strategy in place that may be perceived as less stringent.

[02:15:13] If they intend to do so, there is a form on our website for them to notify us of their intent to deviate, but ultimately because this is guidance and not an executive order, school divisions have the flexibility to make the decisions that they feel like are best for their community. To ensure that we know what's going on in every school district. The health commissioner mandated that all schools or school divisions submit a plan before doing any in-person instruction in phases two and phase three. So that's two separate plans that each school division will have to submit upon entering each phase. Then for the public school divisions only, they're also required to

[02:15:51] submit a plan to us for how they will provide instruction to students during the next academic year. They have to highlight what new instruction will look like, how they will continue to mitigate learning loss and how they could go immediately to remote learning if the conditions in their community require it. So I will race through the phase one and actually, Emily, just jump to phase two since we're

already in phase two. In phase two, which is where we are now, we're predominantly remote. I mentioned all the groups of students that can come in now, but I just wanted to highlight the social distancing measures for you that we're recommending on buses and buildings. That is six

[02:16:28] foot separation wherever possible. Because phase two is primarily summer, we're asking schools to restrict mixing groups of students. So what we mean is not traversing to, you know, different schedules of classes like you would in the traditional school year. The third bullet is governed by an executive order, so there is still a 50-person limit on large gatherings.

[02:16:50] We're recommending that they not use communal spaces, but if they do, that they stagger their use and disinfect. And then I'm going to show you a little bit of flexibility that we've given on athletics. Extracurricular activities as long as they meet the social distancing can continue, but athletics has some very specific guidance and that's on the next slide. Oh the athletic side is not there, so I will summarize the athletic slide and that is to say athletics can continue but we're basically limiting in phase two athletics to be focused on skill building drills, practices, and we're recommending for athletics ten-foot social distancing not six foot. Now you

[02:17:29] may ask why are you doing ten instead of six? Well we did ten because when students are running and exerting more energy it requires more breath and just requires a little bit more physical distance. Competition can start in phase two for those activities that inherently have social distancing so swimming if you stagger start times, cross-country, golf, these types of activities track but but other activities that require contact we're not recommending competition at this time. So now phase three again is all students are able to

[02:18:05] come to school but it will likely require remote instruction due to the social distancing recommendations. Of course child care now before and after school can continue but to accomplish social distancing schools may need to implement staggered schedules. I'm not going to walk you through this document today but the department created a 135 page guide to help schools implement these standards, and inside that is a number of staggered schedule options that schools can continue, could consider. But again, the recommendations for social distancing on buses and buildings, again, six-foot separation. We'll get a new executive order when we get closer

[02:18:43] to phase three on large gatherings. Now we no longer say restrict mixing groups of students, we say consider it. So at high school, that's almost impossible, but in earlier grades, sometimes students would traverse classroom to classroom, say in fifth grade, schools may want consider having one teacher per group of students in fifth grade like they do in k3 and k4 in some cases and then uh like the large gathering limit that will be updated by executive order we will have new guidance on athletics as we get closer to phase three we're working through that with vdh right now and so uh leaving that uh to the next slide there are some precautions that apply to

[02:19:22] all phases of course they must follow the cdc physical and social distancing health and hygiene procedures cleaning and disinfecting procedures and other mitigation strategies i will say the cdc has very specific guidance for communities that have little to no transmission that's a little bit different for school communities that have moderate transmission and so we've been highlighting that with some of our school communities especially uh in southwest virginia and having conversations with them where there's been very little to no transmission thus far we do recommend daily health screenings of students and staff and we have a guidance document on what

[02:19:58] that will look like we do recommend that students and staff who are at higher risk of severe illness remain home but we also give options for students to elect to stay home and so staff are required to wear face coverings when they cannot maintain six foot of social distancing so if they're at the front of the room teaching staff should wear staff does not have to wear their mask but if they're walking up to a student's desk we ask students staff to wear masks for students it's never required but we encourage the use of face coverings especially where it's most developmentally appropriate and and as students get older and we encourage it even more stringently when physical

[02:20:36] distancing cannot be maintained and so leaving that slide Emily to the next one uh there are three detailed guidance documents I would point you to and I can share my screen later if you want to see any of these but there's a more detailed phase guidance document produced by the governor's office that was updated July, June 15th, with the information on how to deviate from our guidance.

[02:20:59] The CDC guidance is very detailed, and like I said, it has information on little to no transmission all the way to moderate and high transmission. And then, of course, the Recover, Redesign and Restart is the 135-page document put together by the agency in partnership with three or four different task forces that we held with well over 100 stakeholders that helped us put that together.

[02:21:20] so before i wrap up mr gecker just a huge kudos to the agency and all the folks in the field that helped us put this together and certainly can answer any questions that the board has about the opening plan okay thank you i don't see any questions mr gecker i'd like to if i may sure i'll try to be brief dr lane you and your team have done amazing work and it's a very difficult needle you're trying to thread to protect safety of students and

[02:21:59] and staff while we try to resume in-person education we heard luminous public comment from parents who are just desperate for schools to resume their child care role and particularly as the economy reopens parents are many parents are very very fearful about what they're going to be able to and they need to go back to work themselves and schools are only in a partial way and so I just ask that you all continue to look options as the

[02:22:39] research comes in as there are more ways to as we gain more knowledge depending progress of the pandemic if there are ways we can help school figure out how they can accommodate really just the very core custodial function schools provide especially for younger children you know are there space enhancements tents can we use the cafeteria to do more classes and small recognizing that may take more money because you'll have to have more adults I don't know what what the options are but yeah we are hearing the cry of the

[02:23:16] parent I just wanted to register that yeah and I will say we've been working we meet with our superintendents twice a week for the past few weeks we meet with them every week on Tuesdays, no matter what. And we've talked at length about the need to create not just plans for the health and safety of students, but partnerships and creative ideas to help parents with child care. I know many of them are working with nonprofit partners like the Y and the United Way and the Boys and Girls Club. Other school divisions are looking at putting in other mitigation strategies that may allow more students to come into the building.

[02:23:50] Others are creating policies where, you know, two-parent working families or single-parent family houses or even the staff the students of the children of teachers have special flexibility to access the building more often they're certainly looking at flexible space options uh the faith community has been

stepping up and offering options and so um i think one of the things that will really help is that school divisions start to roll their plans out parents will have more information around how they're thinking about the child care issue but as jenna to mention before, the child care community, at least the fee for service child care community

[02:24:25] is open. And so I think it's going to be a multifaceted approach. And then if the data trend continues like it has, certainly we could be expediting through phase three faster than people think. And so we're going to look through all of those factors and continue to provide guidance and funding to the child care community to support this need. But certainly hear the voices of parents, and I think that our guidance is governed and set by the VDH in partnership with the department, but I think ultimately

[02:25:03] the flexibility allowed of local school divisions to be creative will be there. Thank you. Okay, thank you, James, and thanks to the department. We appreciate your giving the briefing. Mr. Gecker, I'm sorry, could I make one comment? Yes, you may.

[02:25:20] Thank you. Dr. Lane, really appreciate the update. Very helpful in pointing us to the documents that are available to the public about restarting and reopening. But something that Jenna Conway said about the preschool age population that struck me, and I wrote it down, I think it applies here. When kids come back, what she said is kids may not be okay when they come back to school. She was talking about the preschool age children. But I think that's an important thing for us to remember and for our school divisions I know that we have the logistics that we're thinking about right now as well as some other things but just the emphasis on

[02:26:01] honestly the trauma that our children our students will be coming back to our schools with and ensuring that our localities I know they are thinking about our school divisions are thinking about how we support our students but we have teachers who will be coming back who have been you know through this last several months as well as our parents so all of the transitions i think is something that we need to certainly keep on our radar as we all transition back to what will be the new normal or a normal yeah thank you for that comment uh the and it's one of the

[02:26:40] reasons our guidance is called recover first then redesign and restart and if you if you get a chance to read our big book as we call it the recovery design restart document it there's two there's two major focus areas in that we're centering equity in that document and we're actually hearing from other states that are trying to replicate our equity audit that we recommended to school divisions but second on that to that is the largest section of the book is on student staff support and on on the major needs that students and it's not just students though dr. Wilson it will be staff that are coming back with with some social and

[02:27:16] emotional and mental health support as they think about their own anxiety and their own safety. So thank you for that. And we certainly made that a huge highlight of our recommendations as schools make their plans. Dr. Wilson, I would say, because to that point, I sit on, I guess, three of the task forces that are floating around about this, including the SREB one, you know, the departments and the state one. You know, when those task forces started, there was a pretty significant emphasis on how are we going to, you know, bridge the gap that that we've lost in terms of educational content.

[02:27:51] You know, we had been talking about summer school and I get contacted by teachers now who say, how am I ever gonna catch them up? And to James' point, you know, the focus of all of the task forces

and particularly the Virginia one has shifted from how are we gonna catch up the educational content to how are we gonna best support our kids as they come back?

[02:28:13] And, you know, very healthy change in attitude. And I think a relief to the teachers because as James just said, they too are gonna need to be supported and the pressure to make up the lost academic content, I think would just be too much.

[02:28:29] And so the goal is take this step at a time, welcome people back, heal them to the extent we can, and then begin the process of education in the way we used to think of it before the pandemic.

[02:28:45] James, is that close to accurate or is that? - I agree with you completely. thank you mr president i know our time is running short but on that point that you just made i do think to the extent that there are things that will decisions that will need to be made about those overarching pressure points that will be in the back of the minds of teachers and staff around what is this going to mean as we think about assessments down the line too early to to make calls on those things but it will be important to to not tarry extensively with that

[02:29:25] because that will be operating in the back of folks minds and i know this isn't a time to stand down on expectations but the recognition that this is truly an unprecedented time of tremendous anxiety um as people wrap their minds around coming back and all the fears they may have around that it's going to be important that the things that can be controlled around uh free-floating anxiety we do spend some time being ahead of the curve and not behind the curve

[02:29:58] on settling such things i think the short answer then james i'll let you do this is we are obviously well aware of this uh right now you know i've seen statements put out by you know james that you know right now there is no federal waiver from the testing requirement coming up however and i don't think we have taken action yet on the impact well on the accreditation system and so it may be that we end up having testing but not have it factor into accreditation

[02:30:34] you know as accreditation gets waived going forward to relieve some of that pressure uh we won't know and remember again when this started and james you're better perhaps to deal with this than I am, you know, Virginia did not immediately go for the waiver.

[02:30:50] We were waiting for Texas for a little while because of the politics of it, and the federal department of ed was not freely granting waivers. They had originally said no blanket waivers, and then they sort of backed off of that. We don't know what will happen going forward here, but we can control the impact of the testing on things like accreditation, and I expect that's part of what this board will look at as we move forward.

[02:31:14] And I know Diane sat on the committee to study this. I've seen their recommendations. And I think even if we cannot get away from the testing at all, we can get away from the high stakes nature of the testing and thus relieve anxiety.

[02:31:35] And yeah, Mr. Gecker, I will just tell you what I've been saying publicly. If you don't mind, correct one thing. We were among the states in the early chorus of asking for waivers. We actually put out a statement requesting waivers before they were granted, and then we applied for them.

[02:31:53] But you are correct that our conversations with kind of the major national associations right now is that it's not looking like the federal government is looking to issue waivers on the testing system.

But I can say pretty openly that if there's a waiver opportunity offered, we will give strong favorable consideration to that.

[02:32:19] I can't say exactly what we would do until we see what schools open like, but we understand that this is a time where reducing pressure and trauma is really important. And especially if our schools open in a staggered phase, the accountability metrics don't hold the same reliability and validity to me.

[02:32:41] Additionally, I will say, to Mr. Gecker's point, if we open schools in either phase one, two, or three, it is our intent to come discuss with you. We're still working through the flexibility that I have to make this decision, but assuming that I can make this decision for a second, it is our intent to waive the accreditation system if we open in phases one, two, or three for next year.

[02:33:07] You've already waived it for this year. Yes. Thank you. Thank you. we have at least one other item I wanted to discuss today. You know, a couple of references that were made both in the talks, well, in the talks and in general comments about sort of the situation the country is facing today. I think somebody said now more than ever, the equity piece is important. And, you know, from the board's perspective, I think it's fair to say that it is not just important now, the equity issue or the issue of providing

[02:33:44] equitable opportunity to all of our children has been one that's been focused on by this board for quite some time. A number of organizations have, you know, made statements with regard to this. And, you know, Jamel, I don't know, Dr. Wilson, are you prepared to talk about this or do you want me to do this piece? Mr. Gecker, you're welcome to start and then I'll chime in. You may chime in now if you'd like, if you have, I guess, again, this is the timepiece, although I don't want to brush this because of its importance, but if you would like to talk about a statement from the board, that would be great.

[02:34:24] All right. So as Mr. Gecker has started his comments, certainly we are all watching what's going on around us, what's going on in our country, literally across the world as it relates to social injustice and people speaking up about their dissatisfaction with that. Not just those who are watching, but more importantly, those who are experiencing these things firsthand.

[02:34:52] I think it's fair to say that as a board, we have recognized the importance of equity and education. We began that conversation certainly with the development and adoption of our comprehensive plan.

[02:35:09] We have been doubling down on those areas of priority and weaving and ensuring that each of the issues and decisions we've taken are certainly seeded and supported and founded in this notion of equity of educational opportunity and access.

[02:35:32] And so in thinking about our position as a board over time, since I've been on the board honestly, since 2017 and even a bit prior to that. Up to this point, this moment in time that we are in, we thought it might be useful for us as a board to affirm, acknowledge and recommit our focus. This is not new for us, but in this particular moment, taking a stand, making a stand, speaking up alongside those others who are doing so. Again, to reaffirm

[02:36:08] what it is we believe about the accessibility the absolute necessity for quality education and our responsibility to provide that here in the commonwealth of virginia and so with that as a backdrop we have proposed or have developed a statement to that effect and so dr doran if you are ready i would like to ask him to read the statement and then if there are comments or suggestions mr gecker with your approval um perhaps board members may want to have a word i

[02:36:45] do know that we are cognizant of our time so um if it's okay with you if dr duran could read the statement yeah i'm prepared um mr gecker would you like me to go ahead yes please okay thank you um dr wilson um the history of people of color particularly black americans in our country is a history of strength, perseverance, courageous struggle, agency, and hope.

[02:37:14] But we also know that history is marked by exploitation, oppression, disenfranchisement, and discrimination. As part of broader systems of oppression, people of color have been denied access to the schoolhouse based on the color of their skin. The fight for equal access to public education is long-standing and endures to this day.

[02:37:36] The brave actions of Mary Peake, Barbara Johns, Ruby Bridges, the Norfolk 17 and countless other students, parents and civil rights leaders help break down racial barriers to education. The board recognizes that equal access to a high quality public education is a fundamental right of all Virginians, regardless of race, gender, creed, color or sexual orientation.

[02:38:02] However, systemic racism and discrimination still exists in public education, and too often a student's skin color or socioeconomic status predicts the quality of their educational opportunities. As educational leaders in the Commonwealth, we have a responsibility to recognize and confront such racism and discrimination.

[02:38:25] The Virginia Board of Education is committed to ensuring that Virginia students learn and understand the complex and often untold history of Black Americans in Virginia and our nation. And through the work of the Commission on African American History Education, a review of Virginia's history standards of learning, instructional practices, and professional development supports underway with the recommendations due on September 1st, 2020. Further, the Virginia Department of Education is revising its process for reviewing all standards of learning so that all voices are

[02:39:01] being heard during the revision process and as part of the statutory duty to establish the educational objectives for the commonwealth the board is committed to making the necessary revisions to the virginia standards of learning to ensure there is an accurate and comprehensive history and contributions of from black americans and that is taught in virginia's public schools further the board remains committed to prioritizing equity in every facet of virginia's public education system to ensure that every child receives what they need when they need it to

[02:39:36] access a high-quality public education. This vision of equity extends across race, socioeconomic status, and regional diversity. In October 2019, the board prescribed revised standards of quality and advocated for their implementation during the 2020 General Assembly in order for the Commonwealth to make progress towards equity of opportunity and outcome for all of Virginia's students. The current system of funding for our schools, codified as the standards of quality, has not resulted in meaningful changes in educational outcomes. In fact, in combined effect

[02:40:12] with the previously long-standing standards of accreditation, segregation in our schools has increased. We've seen resources, in terms of funding and personnel, migrate to schools and localities that disproportionately serve fewer students of color, and the result has been a recognized achievement gap that continues to persist. The Board of Education stands firm in its conviction that the state needs to change how it structures public education funding and how much it provides to public schools, primarily through the standards of quality. Without such

[02:40:46] action, we believe that student achievement gaps easily predicted by race and socioeconomic status will stubbornly persist as they have for decades. An environment that fosters personal growth and economic opportunity is foundational to broader societal equality. Education is the precursor to both, and without a meaningful change to public education funding in Virginia, we believe that the unacceptable results we see today won't change. Therefore, today, the board recommits to making good on the promise of a high-quality education for every child by eliminating racial

[02:41:25] and socioeconomic inequities in Virginia's public education system. The board calls on the Virginia General Assembly to make progress on funding and implementing concepts embedded in the 2019 standards of quality in order to close the achievement gap and advanced equity of opportunity and outcome for Virginia students.

[02:41:45] Additionally, the board calls on fellow education leaders across the Commonwealth to examine policies, procedures and funding through the lens of racial inequity to implement necessary reform to ensure children of every race have equal access to educational opportunity. Virginia's educational leaders have a shared responsibility to deliver on the promise of a high-quality education for every child, and together with intentional action to dismantle racism and eliminate achievement gaps, we can fulfill that promise for every learner. Thank you, Mr. President, for letting me read

[02:42:24] the joint statement from the board, and I will turn it back to you. I'm sorry before you make your comments. I think that was a lot of words and for those who are watching and listening. It may be hard to get a flavor, but again, I'll just reiterate the way I started the work of this board has been ongoing in this area of providing equitable opportunity.

[02:42:48] And this is the lens that we have been using over the last several years. And for those who have been watching our work. We hope you see that consistency throughout that time and can be assured through this statement that reaffirms our commitment, that this is an area that we will persist in so that we are able to dismantle what we see as inequity in our public education system, providing high quality education, living into our mission and our purpose for existing.

[02:43:20] So Mr. Gecker, thank you for that time. And I turn the floor back to you. Thank you. Is there anybody else who'd like to comment before I do? Just briefly to thank you and Dr. Wilson for the hard work in coming up with a very strong draft that recommits us to this important work.

[02:43:42] I would say there is one change, unfortunately, I want to do here, which is in the last paragraph, when we say Virginia's educational leaders have a shared responsibility, I think it ought to be just Virginia's leaders have a shared responsibility.

[02:43:59] because I think it goes to everybody. I'm not gonna repeat what Dr. Wilson said, but I will say that this board touches a lot of things. I don't think there's anything we do that's more important than this, than what we're saying here.

[02:44:19] The work with the board towards the standards of quality revisions, toward providing equal access, equal opportunity, and equity of outcome for our students in my mind the most important thing that we do and will have the greatest impact on uh our society on benefiting all people in the commonwealth you know if you look back to you know why do we have a system of free public education it is preservation of democracy it is providing equal opportunity in

[02:44:55] the economic life of uh you know the commonwealth and frankly it is to maximize everybody's opportunity to fulfill themselves personally. This is in fact about, you know, equality, it's about equity, and you know, I hope that the board will pass this and adopt this as a formal statement today. Is there a motion to do that? Mr. Gecker, I don't mind. In fact, I would like to move that

[02:45:29] the board, Virginia Board of Education, adopt this joint statement that was just read by Dr. francisco duran thank you with the one change if you don't mind is that yes that is correct with the one change that mr gecker identified um talking about virginia's leaders all leaders having a response a shared responsibility to deliver thank you is there a second dr duran thank you we'll do roll call on this as everything ms atkinson i absolutely uh miss davis

[02:46:06] Welcome. I'm glad you made it. Thank you very much. Aye. I agree. Dr. Duran. Aye. Ms. Holton. Aye. Dr. Mann. Amen. Aye. Dr. Pexton. Aye. And Dr. Wilson. Aye. And I, of course, am voting aye. I want to thank you all very much for taking this strong stand. It says a lot about who you are and about who we are.

[02:46:35] So I think I must, well, I should ask, is there any other items that you'd like to discuss under this topic on the agenda? You know, I don't see any.

[02:46:51] And so with the informative note that the committee, special committee to review standards of accreditation begins at 1. For those of you who. Sorry, President Gecker. we are going to start we're going to delay the special committee meeting by 15 minutes to give folks a little bit of time to stretch we're going to start at 1 15. i appreciate that and with that note and correction we are adjourned thank you all very much thank you

